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碩士論文

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高中生語言學習策略選擇之研究

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研究生：鐘英慈 撰

中華民國九十一年六月

國立彰化師範大學英語學系

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Language Learning Strategy Choices of Senior High School Students

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TO MY BELOVED

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中文摘要

本研究之目的在於調查台灣高中生英語學習策略的選擇傾向。藉由 MacIntyre 於 1994 年所提出之社會心理模組之檢驗，以及調查學生在選擇或使用語言學習策略所遇到的困難及焦慮，來瞭解學生在選擇或使用語言學習策略的傾向為何。本研究的受測者為台灣中部地區 178 位高中二年級學生。研究方法主要為問卷調查法。

研究結果指出，MacIntyre 於 1994 年提出的社會心理模組在預測台灣高中生的英語學習策略使用上效果並不良好；此模組僅預測到 SILL (Oxford, 1989) 問卷中 50 個語言學習策略的 23 個策略，平均預測力為 53%。同時，研究結果也顯示，在社會心理模組中的四個變數，也就是對策略的認識，策略的有效程度，使用策略的困難度，以及使用策略所引起焦慮的程度，均與語言學習策略的使用頻率有顯著相關。而在這四個變數中，對策略的認識，使用策略的困難度，以及使用策略所引起焦慮的程度，在預測語言學習策略的使用上，預測力較策略的有效程度高。

此外，研究結果並顯示，學生對語言學習策略的不熟悉、英語能力的缺乏、外語學習環境、困窘的感覺、被動的學習態度以及沈重的課業壓力是引起學生在使用語言學習策略上主要的六項困難。在使用策略之前，使用策略期間以及使用策略之後均有可能會引起焦慮。在使用策略之前，引起焦慮的原因可能是害怕犯

錯及丟臉；在使用策略時，可能引起焦慮的原因為犯錯、丟臉、以及使用策略時所產生的不確定感；而使用策略之後，因使用策略不當所產生的負面影響，則為引起焦慮的可能原因。在論文最後，作者並進一步討論本研究在英語教學與語言學習策略訓練的應用及建議。

關鍵詞：語言學習策略，高中生，英語學習

Language Learning Strategy Choices of Senior High School

Students

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Abstract

Originating from the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994), the current study, with 178 senior high school Taiwanese students, aimed to locate the predictors of language learning strategy choices and examine the difficulties and anxieties encountered by the students when choosing or using language learning strategies. The research method employed was surveys. The researcher first tested the social-psychological model, and the difficulties and anxieties in choosing or using language learning strategies were then investigated. The results of the test of the model indicated that the predictability of the social-psychological model was relatively weak; it predicted 23 out of 50 learning strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989), with an average predictability of 53%. Significant correlation coefficients, however, were found between the strategy use frequency and the four social-psychological variables, *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty* and *anxiety*. Moreover, the variables, *knowledge*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*, were stronger predictors than the variable *effectiveness* in accounting for the strategy use frequency.

Among the various difficulties encountered by the participants when applying language learning strategies, there were six difficulties reported by most of the participants. They were the unfamiliarity of language learning strategies, the requirement of English ability, the EFL language learning environment, the feeling of being embarrassed, the passive

learning attitude, and the heavy academic load from school. It was shown that anxieties would be raised before, during, and after the application of language learning strategies. Possible factors that caused anxieties before using a strategy were the fear of making mistakes and getting embarrassed. When using a strategy, the fact of making mistakes and getting embarrassed, and the feeling of uncertainty when using a strategy were the possible factors that raised anxieties. Anxieties were also raised because of the negative feelings after applying learning strategies. At the end of the study, pedagogical implications and suggestions based on the results at senior high school Taiwanese students were provided.

Key words: language learning strategies, senior high school students, English learning

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

Background

Studies on learners' use of language learning strategies, in the beginning, focus on successful language learners and try to identify factors contributing to their success. Rubin and Thompson, for example, provided a list of characteristics of good language learners (1982). Following this line of thought, later researchers work on the definition and typology of language learning strategies (Chamot, 1987; O'Malley & Chamot, 1990; Oxford, 1990), explore language learning strategies used by learners, and suggest that appropriate use of learning strategies can serve as a predictor of successful language learning. For example, language learning strategies have been examined and reported to successfully assist language learning (Rubin 1987; Wenden & Rubin, 1987; Chamot & Kupper, 1989; O'Malley & Chamot, 1990; Oxford, 1990; Green & Oxford, 1995; Park, 1997).

Within all of these studies on the definition, identification, and efficiency of language learning strategies used by learners, many researchers find that learners do not use as many language learning strategies as they could (Ehrman & Oxford 1989; Oxford & Crookall 1989; Cohen, 1990; MacIntyre & Noels, 1996). In order to probe more deeply into language learning strategy use, variables affecting language learning strategy choices in recent years have been investigated (Oxford & Nyikos, 1989; Yang, 1992, 1993, 1994; Ku, 1995, Yutaka, 1997; Ho, 1999). In 1994, MacIntyre proposed that social-psychological variables are important in affecting learners' choices of language learning strategies. In this model, strategy use primarily depends on three factors: 1) having the knowledge of the strategy, 2) having a reason to use it, and 3) having no reason not to use it (without difficulties or anxieties when using it). In 1996, MacIntyre and Noels examined this model (MacIntyre, 1994). They found that this model could successfully predict 35 learning strategies in the

SILL (Oxford, 1989) and the four social-psychological variables together predict 60 percent of the use of language learning strategies.

Despite such a great deal of literature in the field of language learning strategies, few studies focus on the EFL language learning environment in Taiwan (Yang, 1991; Yang, 1993; Yang, 1992, 1993, 1994, Ku, 1995; Huang, 1997; Teng, 1998; Ho, 1999; Lin, 2000; Chang & Huang, 1999; Liao, 2000; Wang, 2002). Ku noted this fact in her 1995 study.

Among the studies focusing on EFL learners in Taiwan, even fewer studies involved senior high school students as participants (Yang, 1991; Yang, 1993; Ku, 1995; Huang, 1997; Lin, 2000, Wang, 2002). As Huang (1997) noted in her study, senior high school students are the ones receiving the least attention in this field. As this is the case, there is a need for researchers to conduct studies on language learning strategies in the EFL environment in Taiwan, especially on senior high school students.

With an interest to discover the variables affecting learners' choices of language learning strategies, and with the need to investigate senior high school students' application of learning strategies, the researcher decided to conduct this site study. The researcher started with the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) and tried to apply the model in predicting the frequency of strategy use of senior high school students in Taiwan. Further, the researcher investigated the possible difficulties and anxieties that senior high school students in Taiwan might encounter in choosing or using language learning strategies.

Purpose

The purposes of this study, therefore, are to investigate the factors affecting language learning strategy use by senior high school students in Taiwan. This was done by using the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) to predict the students' strategy use and by exploring the possible difficulties and anxieties when the participants choose or use strategies.

For the first purpose of this study, the social-psychological model (MacIntyre, 1994) was used to predict the strategy use frequency of the participants. In this model, the variables are 1) *knowledge*, that is, to know the strategy, 2) *effectiveness*, that is, to feel that the strategy is efficient, 3) *difficulty*, that is, there are no difficulties to use the strategy, and 4) *anxiety*, that is, the use of the strategy does not result in anxieties. To successfully predict a strategy to be used, the four variables must follow the pattern that the variable *knowledge* and the variable *effectiveness* are required, and, either the variable *difficulty* or the variable *anxiety* is required. However, when out of the model, the four variables are also predictors of language learning strategies. Therefore, in this study, the predictability of the social-psychological model was examined both from the general view of the whole model and from the specific view of the four variables.

The use of the social-psychological model (MacIntyre, 1994) provided us with results in statistical numbers. We could only ascertain the predictability of the model in terms of numbers. The second purpose of this study, therefore, was to deepen our understanding about the students' strategy use by investigating the possible difficulties and anxieties of the participants in choosing or using language learning strategies. The possible difficulties and anxieties for senior high school students in choosing or using learning strategies would be investigated by qualitative research method.

Research Questions

Two research questions were addressed as follows.

1. How successful is the predictability of the social-psychological model when being applied to senior high school students in Taiwan?
2. What are the possible difficulties and anxieties for senior high school students in choosing or using language learning strategies?

Rationale

Rising with the awareness of the importance of language learning strategies in language learning, together with the shift from teacher-centered language teaching to learner-centered language learning in education, language learning strategies, which result in self-directed and autonomous learners, have been the focus of recent research. Much research has already explored the field of language learning strategies, and has validated the efficiency of language learning strategies in improving language proficiency.

However, aside from the investigation of the definition, typology, and identification of language learning strategies, it is necessary to explore the reasons learners use language learning strategies. As it is reported by previous research, learners do not use as many strategies as they could to assist their learning (Ehrman & Oxford 1989; Oxford & Crookall 1989; Cohen, 1990; MacIntyre & Noels, 1996). Studies in recent years thus focused on variables affecting learners' choices of language learning strategies (Oxford & Nyikos, 1989; Yang, 1992, 1993, 1994; Ku, 1995, Huang, 1997; Yutaka, 1997; Chang & Huang, 1999; Ho, 1999; Liao, 2000). As long as we know why and how some strategies are used, educators and learning strategy trainers can effectively equip students and learners with learning strategies.

To teach learners language learning strategies efficiently, teachers and trainers must know the factors affecting learning strategy choices. The studies of factors affecting strategy use identify motivation, anxiety, age, maturity, learning stage, and sex as important factors. While these factors have been examined separately, MacIntyre proposed a theoretical social-psychological model to predict learning strategy use in 1994. In 1996, MacIntyre and Noels further examined this model in the EFL context and found that 35 strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989) were predicted, and the four social-psychological variables together accounted for 60 percent of the variance of the frequency of strategy use.

As the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) showed a relatively strong predictability in predicting language learning strategy use, the researcher decided to apply the model to Taiwanese EFL students. By applying this model, the researcher wanted to know whether the model and the variables themselves are good predictors of the strategy choices of the learners in Taiwan. In addition, to deepen the understanding about learners' strategy use, the researcher decided to investigate the reasons that learners do not choose certain learning strategies, trying to identify the possible difficulties and anxieties that learners encountered when choosing or using learning strategies. Knowing the factors influencing strategy use can contribute to strategy teaching and training. Teachers and strategy trainers can know the reasons that learners use a strategy and thus train learning strategies more efficiently.

In Taiwan, senior high school students are required to study English. The students learn English skills both in linguistic and communicative competence. Therefore, they have many chances to employ language learning strategies, and they have the need to use language learning strategies to assist their English learning. However, for educators to equip their students with language learning strategies more efficiently, it is important for them to know the factors affecting the use of strategies. That is, to know in what situation their students may use a strategy, and in what situation they may not use a strategy. As long as the factors affecting learners' strategy choices are specified, teachers can make good use of those that help, and try to overcome those that do not help. Therefore, it is necessary to conduct this study to find out the efficient predictors of strategy use and to know possible difficulties and anxieties that prevent senior high school students in Taiwan from using a strategy.

Researchers have focused on Taiwan EFL learners and identified variables affecting learners' choices of learning strategies, such as proficiency, motivation, and learning beliefs (Yang, 1991; Yang, 1993; Yang, 1993, 1994; Ku, 1995; Ho, 1999; Huang, 1997; Chang & Huang, 1999; Liao, 2000). Among these studies, only a few of them concern the learning

strategy use of senior high students (Yang, 1991; Yang, 1993; Ku, 1995; Huang, 1997; Lin, 2000; Wang, 2002). Results of these studies have shown that gender, achievement, motivation, proficiency, and language learning beliefs are variables influencing the choices of learning strategies of senior high school students in Taiwan. Although it is important to explore the strategy use in senior high school students, there are rather few studies on this population (Ku, 1995; Huang, 1997). With personal interest and the need of an investigation into the strategy use of senior high students in Taiwan, the researcher chose senior high school students in Taiwan as the participants and conducted this study.

Significance

The results of this study will first contribute to the EFL teaching and learning of senior high schools. By knowing the reasons for learners' use of learning strategies, teachers can equip students with the knowledge of learning strategies more efficiently. With research based on the knowledge of learning strategies, learners can use language learning strategies more effectively and appropriately to improve language learning.

In addition, with the rapidly growth of studies in learning strategy training, knowing the predictors and the possible difficulties and anxieties should benefit language learning strategy training. Trainers can make use of the predictors and overcome the difficulties and anxieties so that the training process can move on more smoothly and the effect can be enhanced.

This study can also serve as a study of research in the field of language learning strategies, especially in the sub-field of the investigation of variables affecting language learning strategy use of senior high school students in Taiwan. This study may provide insights to those who are interested in this field.

Definitions of Terms

There are several terms used in this study, and it is necessary to provide the definition of those terms.

1. Language learning strategies: the definition of the term “language learning strategies” is “the actions chosen by language students that are intended to facilitate language acquisition and communication” (MacIntyre, 1994, p. 190). Actions, which are deliberately used to assist language learning, are regarded as “language learning strategies”. As a result, the possibility of the unawareness of learning strategy use, the ineffectiveness of learning strategies, and the situational and learner characteristics, are excluded in this study. In other words, only the intention is considered (MacIntyre, 1994).
2. The social-psychological model: the model was proposed by MacIntyre in 1994. In this model, it is assumed that a language learner will use a strategy if he/she knows the strategy, feels the strategy efficient, and has no reason not to use it, that is, feels it is not difficult to use and feels no anxiety when using it. Therefore, the model aims to use these four variables in the pattern to predict language learners’ strategy use frequency. In this model, the variable of knowing a strategy is required, the variable of feeling a strategy efficient is required, and the variables of having no reason not to use a strategy, either feeling no difficulty or feeling no anxiety is required, because either one can prevent the strategy use.

The operationalized definitions of the variables in the social-psychological model are specified as the following. *Knowledge* is referred to as the degree to which the learners are aware of a strategy and its use. The rating of *effectiveness*, regarded as the reason for students to use a strategy, is referred to as the degree to which the learners feel the efficiency of a strategy. As to the reasons not to use a

strategy, *difficulty* and *anxiety* are included as these two factors may prevent students from using a strategy (MacIntyre & Noels, 1996). The rating of *difficulty* is referred to as the degree of difficulty to which the learners feel when using a strategy, and the rating of *anxiety* is referred to as the degree of anxiety to which the learners feel when using a strategy. It has to be made clear that there are other variables affecting learning strategy use; however, for the present study to test the social-psychological model, only these four variables are included.

3. SILL: the SILL represents the Strategy Inventory of Language Learning (Oxford, 1989), which consists 50 language learning strategies.
4. ESL: English as a second language
5. EFL: English as a foreign language
6. Senior high school: the secondary education after three-year compulsory junior high school education. Senior high school education generally provides students with preparation for further education, such as education in college or university.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

The Importance of Language Learning Strategies

Initiated by Rubin and Thompson (1982) in the identification of the characteristics of good language learners, researchers have paid more and more attention to language learning strategies. Various topics have been discussed, such as the definition of learning strategies, the taxonomy of learning strategies, the identification of learning strategies used in different groups, the effect of using learning strategies, the variables affecting learners' choices of learning strategies, and more recently, learning strategy training. For example, Oxford in 1990 discussed the definition, taxonomy and characteristics of language learning strategies. Park in 1997 conducted research into the identification of the language learning strategies used by university students and the role that language learning strategies play in language learning. The relationship between language learning strategies and other variables, such as beliefs, proficiency, or motivation, have all been examined (Yang, 1993; Park, 1997; Huang, 1997; Chang & Huang, 1999).

Studies have reported the fact that utilizing language learning strategies appropriately improves language proficiency and learning achievement, both in overall English proficiency and specific skills (Wenden & Rubin, 1987; Chamot & Kupper, 1989; O' Malley & Chamot, 1990). Studies have also reported that successful language learners generally use learning strategies more adequately than do poor learners (Rubin 1987; Chamot & Kupper, 1989; Oxford, 1990; Green and Oxford, 1995; Park, 1997). For example, Vann and Abraham in 1990, reported that the differences between successful and unsuccessful learners lie, firstly, in the degree of flexibility that learners show when choosing strategies, and, secondly, in the extent that chosen strategies are applied appropriately to the given situation. In 1991, Oxford et al. further claimed that effective students use language learning strategies more

consciously, more purposefully, more appropriately, and more frequently than do less able students.

The importance of language learning strategies lies not only in the assistance of language proficiency and learning achievement, but also in its leading learners to independent, self-directed, autonomous, and life-long learning. Oxford (1990) defined language learning strategies as “specific actions used by learners to make learning more easier, faster, more enjoyable, more self-directed, more effective, and more transferable to new situations” (p. 8). Language learning strategies result in improved proficiency, greater self-confidence, and encourage greater overall self-direction for learners. In 1991, Wenden claimed that autonomous learners have acquired the learning strategies, the knowledge about learning, and the attitudes that enable them to use these skills and knowledge confidently, flexibly, appropriately and independently of a teacher. Sy (1995) also claimed that autonomous language learners need techniques that enable them to manage their self-directed learning, and suggested that strategy training can foster autonomy.

Research has pointed out the importance of language learning strategies, and has suggested that learners need to be equipped with the knowledge about language learning strategies. As a response to the need, followers provide guidelines for educators and teachers to teach language learning strategies (Wenden, 1987, 1991; Oxford, 1990; Brown, 1994). Following the guidelines, research has been conducted to validate the teachability of language learning strategies (O’Malley, 1987; Yang, 1995, 1996; Chiu, 1999; Jiang, 2001). However, mixed results of the effect of language learning strategy training have been reported.

Oxford and Crookall (1989), after surveying research on language learning strategies, pointed out that “some/most learners are relatively unaware of the strategies they use and do not take advantage of the full range of available strategies” (p. 413). Other researchers

agreed with this point and also claimed that learners do not use as many language learning strategies as possible (Ehrman & Oxford 1989; Cohen, 1990; MacIntyre & Noels, 1996). As a result, locating variables affecting language learning strategy choices becomes an important task, which can help researchers understand learners' language learning strategy use, and help educators and trainers modify their guidelines in equipping learners with learning strategies.

Variables Affecting Language Learning Strategy Use

Researchers have been working on the factors that affect language learning strategy use. Learning belief, language proficiency, gender, cultural background, motivation, and so on, have all been reported as factors that correlate with and/or influence learning strategy use. These studies not only report variables affecting learning strategy use but also contribute to the field of investigation into language learning strategies.

The following literature review of the variables affecting learning strategy choices is divided into three categories. The three categories are the studies in the ESL environment, in the EFL environment, and in Taiwan specifically.

Studies in the ESL Environment

Wenden (1987), when investigating the possible relationship between learners' explicit beliefs and their approach to language learning, interviewed 25 ESL adult learners. The researcher found that in some cases, the participants described their learning strategy choices as being consistent with their beliefs. For example, learners who thought that it is important to repeat and practice a lot would probably spend time on formal practicing.

Oxford and Nyikos in 1989, by investigating 1200 ESL learners' strategy use, reported several variables affecting the choices of learning strategies. Results showed that motivation was the factor that had the most powerful influence; sex also affected the choices of learning strategies in a profound way; other factors, such as proficiency ratings, elective versus required status, years of study, major, and interactions among these factors, were all reported

as affecting the choices of learning strategies. Students who were more motivated used all kinds of strategies more often than those who were less motivated. Female students tended to use more strategies than male ones in formal rule-related practice strategies, general study strategies, and conversational input elicitation strategies. Students whose majors were humanities, social science, and education tended to use more functional practice strategies and resourceful, independent strategies. Greater learning strategy use was reported in perceptions of higher proficiency. Students who learned the language as an elected subject used strategies more often, and students who had at least four- or five-year studying abroad experience used strategies more often.

Green and Oxford in 1995 studied learning strategies, second language proficiency and gender. Three hundred and seventy four students were involved in this study. The results indicated greater use of learning strategies in higher proficiency students and female students. However, the significant variation did not include all learning strategies. In fact, the strategies that were used more frequently by more successful students were those active, naturalistic practice strategies, such as, “Ask questions in English” and “Seek opportunities to read in English”. Besides, these strategies were used in combination with a variety of bedrock strategies, which learners at all levels would use frequently or moderately frequently. For example, strategies, such as, “Use new English words in sentences” and “Try to find patterns”, were those used moderately at all course levels.

Studies in the EFL Environment

In 1994, McIntyre proposed a social-psychological model of strategy use. In this model, strategy use was regarded as the response to a communicative demand or a goal that students desired to meet or achieve. This model claimed that there were at least four considerations that must be met before a language learning strategy was used. Firstly, students must be aware of one or more appropriate strategies, which were intentionally and

freely chosen. Secondly, to use a strategy, students must have sufficient motives. These motives included positive attitude, sufficient motivation, appropriate opportunities provided, etc. It was assumed that if students know the strategy well and have a reason to use it, they will use a learning strategy unless there are reasons not to use it. Therefore, the third consideration was that students should not have reasons not to use a strategy. Reasons, such as ineffectiveness, anxiety when using the strategy, and experiences sanctioning against the strategy use, would be likely to prevent the use of a strategy. Fourthly, strategy use should be reinforced by positive consequences, such as improved learning and communication, reduced anxiety, and rewards. The whole social-psychological influences on strategy use are represented in Figure 1 (MacIntyre, 1994).

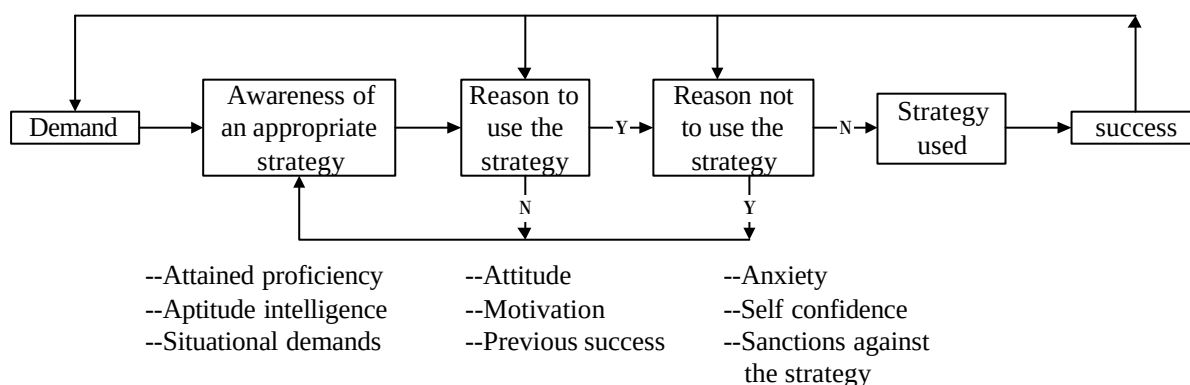


Figure 2.1 The social-psychological model (cited from MacIntyre, 1994)

In 1996, McIntyre and Noels conducted a study to examine the social-psychological model. The researchers applied the model to predict the strategy use of 138 college learners of Spanish and Italian in a Modern Language Department. The results showed that 35 out of 50 strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989) were predicted by the model. The results also showed that about 60 percent of the frequency of strategy use was predicted by the combination of the four social-psychological variables, *knowledge, effectiveness, difficulty*

and *anxiety*. From the specific perspective, *knowledge* failed to predict only two strategies, and *effectiveness* failed to predict nine strategies. Five strategies were not predicted by either *anxiety* or *difficulty*. For the fifty strategies examined, *difficulty* was a significant predictor in forty strategies, but *anxiety* was a significant predictor in only eleven strategies. At the end of the study, McIntyre and Noels concluded that “this model indicates that knowing a strategy well, perceiving it as effective, and not considering it to be difficult to use predict the majority of the variance in strategy use” (p. 384).

Park, by studying 332 Korean students, investigated the relationship between language learning strategies and English proficiency. Major results showed that the relationship between language learning strategies and L2 proficiency was linear. In other words, learners with higher second language proficiency tended to employ more language learning strategies. In addition, all six categories of learning strategies and total learning strategies were significantly correlated with TOEFL scores. Moreover, cognitive and social strategies, which accounted for 13 percent of total variation in the TOEFL scores, were more predictive than other strategies.

Yutaka reviewed studies related to language learning strategies in 1997 and reported eight factors affecting learners’ learning strategy choices. The eight factors were sex, motivation, career orientation, personality, teaching methods, cultural background and experience abroad, age, and classroom tasks given to learners. Generally speaking, female learners used a larger variety of language learning strategies than male learners. The more motivated learners employed strategies more often than the less motivated ones. Students whose majors were social science, education, humanities, and whose career orientation was towards language teaching used a larger variety of learning strategies than others. Teaching methods also influenced students’ language learning strategy choices. For example, grammar-translation method may provide students with more opportunities in learning

memory or practice strategies. Tasks in the classroom also affected students' choices in learning strategies. For example, monitoring strategies were useful in tasks in which attention was required to form.

In 1999, Bremner, by studying the relationship between language learning strategies and language proficiency of 149 Hong Kong participants, found that there was a significant variation in proficiency in relation to eleven strategies in the SILL. Among the eleven strategies, nine of them were cognitive strategies, one was compensation strategy, and one was social strategy. The results also indicated that the participants used compensation and metacognitive strategies the most frequently. Affective and memory strategies were used the least.

Sheorey (1999) investigated learning strategy use in the setting of an indigenized variety of English. In the study, 1261 Indian college students were involved, and results showed that female students tended to use more strategies than male ones, and that high proficiency students tended to use more strategies. Cultural background and educational background were also indicated as factors affecting learning strategy use.

Wharton (2000), by investigating 678 EFL college students in Singapore, found that motivation, self-rated proficiency, and language studied were related to the use of learning strategies. He also found that students with higher proficiency tended to use more strategies, and male students, rather than female ones, used more strategies.

Studies in Taiwan

Yang (1991) investigated the relationship between English learning strategies, learning style, and English aptitude by surveying 977 senior high school students. The results showed that gender affected the choices of learning strategies; female students tended to use more compensation, metacognitive, affective, and social strategies than male students.

In 1993, Yang conducted a study investigating learning strategies and techniques of high-achievement students in senior high school. In this study, the researcher reported that high-achievement students used learning strategies and techniques more frequently than low-achievement students. The results also showed that students with higher achievement used more kinds of learning strategies than those with lower achievement did.

Yang (1993) conducted a study to investigate the relationship between students' beliefs and their use of learning strategies. Results showed that learners' learning beliefs about the value and the nature of learning spoken English were related to the use of formal oral-practice strategies.

In 1994, Yang conducted a study of factors affecting college EFL students' use of learning strategies. In this study, 505 college students were involved, and the results showed that the major being studied and the gender of these college students significantly affected their strategy use. Female students used social strategies more often than male ones. Foreign language majors tended to use functional practice strategies more frequently while language and business majors used metacognitive strategies more often. Science and engineering majors used social strategies the least in comparison to those studying for other majors. Other factors, such as perceived motivation, fondness for learning English, effort, years of English study, frequency of contact with native speakers, and perceived proficiency level, were all reported to show significant influence on the choices of learning strategies. For example, more motivated students used strategies more frequently; the more the students liked to learn English and the more effort and time that they spent studying English, the more often they used learning strategies; greater strategy use was reported in higher grade level; the better the students rated their language proficiency, the more frequently they used strategies; with more chances to contact with native speakers, students would use strategies more frequently.

In 1995, Ku studied language learning strategies of 904 Taiwanese students learning English as a foreign language. The participants were about half male and half female and were chosen from three educational levels (junior high, senior high, and college). In this study, Ku investigated the strategies used most and least frequently by Taiwan EFL students, the strategies that associated with high proficiency, and the predictors of strategy choices. Firstly, the results showed that Taiwan EFL students used compensation strategies most frequently and affective strategies least frequently. Secondly, the use of cognitive and compensation strategies were positively associated with high English proficiency. Thirdly, with the descending rank, motivation, proficiency, gender, and educational level were predictors affecting strategy choices. Among those predictors, motivation and proficiency were significant predictors for junior high students. For senior high and college students, motivation, proficiency, and gender showed their significant predictability on strategy use.

In 1997, Huang conducted a study investigating 312 Taiwan senior high school students' learning belief and learning strategies, and reported a relationship between learning belief and learning strategies. For example, the belief that it is acceptable to guess if one does not know a word in English was related to the participants' use of strategies in making guesses when encountering unknown words. Results also showed that those students were not aware of various useful strategies and did not use many strategies.

In 1999, Ho investigated relationships between motivation, attitude, effort, and English proficiency and English learning strategy use by surveying 372 college students in a national university of technology in Taiwan. The results showed that motivation/attitude, effort, and English proficiency in combination accounted for 47% of the variance in memory strategy use, 60 % in cognitive strategy use, 29.4% in compensation strategy use. The results also showed that motivation/attitude and effort together explained 54% of the variance in metacognitive strategy use, 38% in affective strategy use, and 30% in social strategy use.

In addition, the study also reported on the differences existing between proficient and non-proficient students' strategy use, that is, proficient students tended to use larger variety of learning strategies (all six learning strategy categories), and use them more frequently than non-proficient students.

In 1999, Chang and Huang investigated the relationship among motivation types and intensity and language learning strategies. Sixty Taiwanese graduate and undergraduate students in Indianan University were involved. The results showed that total learning strategy use frequency was positively related to motivation intensity, intrinsic motivation, and extrinsic motivation. Cognitive and metacognitive strategies were positively related to intrinsic motivation, and memory and affective strategies were positively related to extrinsic motivation.

The relationship between motivation and learning strategies was also investigated by Liao in 2000. In this study, different types of motivation and motivation intensity were reported as correlating with strategy use. This study investigated the motivation and learning strategies of 473 junior high school students. The results showed that highly motivated students tended to use more learning strategies, and that both intrinsic and extrinsic motivation were related to the students' choices in the six categories of language learning strategies. For example, cognitive and metacognitive strategies, compared with other strategies, were more strongly related to motivational intensity, intrinsic motivation, and extrinsic motivation.

Lin (2000) conducted a study to investigate the English listening comprehension strategies used by senior high school students in Taiwan. The study not only identified the difference and the difficulty of high-proficiency and low-proficiency students but also indicated that high-proficiency students tended to use listening strategies more frequently and more flexibly.

In 2002, Wang investigated the listening comprehension strategy use of 301 senior high school students, and identified the patterns of the students' listening strategy use. The results indicated that gender and proficiency were significant variables affecting overall learning strategy use. It was also shown that female students and effective listeners tended to use strategies more frequently.

Brief Summary

With so many researchers working on the variables affecting language learning strategy use, various factors have been reported, such as age, gender, and motivation. However, variables affecting the strategy choices of the senior high school students in Taiwan are not fully investigated. Though the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) was reported with a relatively strong predictability of the strategy use of college students, the results can not be directly applied to senior high school students in Taiwan. As a result, more investigation on variables affecting the strategy choices of senior high school students is needed.

CHAPTER THREE

METHODOLOGY

Research Design

This study aimed to investigate the variables affecting the language learning strategy choices of the senior high school students in Taiwan. There are various variables affecting the choices of learning strategies, such as gender, motivation, learning styles, and so on. In this study, the variables included were those involved in the social-psychological model proposed by MacIntyre in 1994. In this model, it assumed that the use of a strategy can be predicted if the learner knows the strategy, feels it effective, and finds no reason not to use it, such as feeling it difficult in application or feeling anxious when using it. The variables in this model were thus *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*. This study investigated the predictability of the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994), both from the general view of the whole model and the specific view of the four variables. The data in the investigation of the predictability of the model was collected by a closed questionnaire with five-point likert scales, and the data collected was computed by the statistical package SPSS (version 10.0).

To understand more about learners' strategy use, the researcher also investigated the possible difficulties and anxieties that learners would encounter when choosing or using learning strategies. This research design was added to compensate for the first research question, the test of the social-psychological model (MacIntyre, 1994), which showed results with statistical numbers. It was the results of the pilot study that showed, to deepen our understanding of learners' strategy use, a qualitative research design to investigate the possible difficulties and anxieties when learners apply learning strategies was required. The qualitative data was collected by an open-ended questionnaire, and the data was analyzed and categorized by the researcher.

Pilot Study-Predictability of the Model and the Four Variables

In order to know the possible obstacles that the researcher might encounter in this study, the researcher conducted a pilot study in 2001 spring. The pilot study thus examined the social-psychological model proposed by MacIntyre in 1994.

The social-psychological model claimed that a strategy is used when the learner knows the strategy well, perceives it as effective, and does not have any reason not to use it. Therefore, there were four variables in this model, and they were *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*; *anxiety* and *difficulty* served as reasons not to use a strategy. In terms of the four variables, the use of a strategy is said to be predicted only when *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, and, either *difficulty* or *anxiety*, show their significant predictability in this model. In 1996, MacIntyre and Noels examined the social psychological model by conducting a study of 138 foreign language learners, and found that 35 learning strategies out of the SILL (Oxford, 1989) were predicted. In addition, the four social-psychological variables, *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*, together accounted for 60 percent of the variance of the frequency of strategy use when not following the pattern in the social psychological model.

The researcher applied the model to Taiwan EFL students to predict their strategy use frequency. In the pilot study, the survey method was chosen as the data collection method, and a questionnaire was used. The questionnaire was the SILL questionnaire developed by Oxford (1989), and translated into Chinese by Yang (1992) and Liao (2000). The researcher further modified the answer part by involving the four variables in the social psychological model (MacIntyre, 1994).

Ninety-nine first-grade senior high school students were involved in this research project. In consideration of not interrupting the proceeding of the classes, the questionnaire was administered by the teachers of the participants. With the teachers' help, the participants

completed the questionnaire during class. The researcher, thus, before the administration, ensured the teachers knew the content and the format of the questionnaire, and the procedure of administration.

A cover letter was also attached as the front page of the questionnaire, in which the nature and the purpose of the study, the answering procedure, the confidentiality, and the appreciation were specified. In addition, the researcher asked the teachers to explain the cover letter to ensure that the students had no questions about the study and the questionnaire.

The data collected was analyzed by the SPSS statistical package for window version 10.0, in terms of stepwise regression. The results of the research project showed that the social psychological model, when applying to Taiwan EFL students, predicted 19 strategies in the SILL, with an average predictability of 64 percent. On the other hand, when the four variables did not follow the pattern required in this model, they together showed 59 percent of significant predictability in strategy use. The possible explanation of the different predictability of the pilot study and the study of MacIntyre and Noels (1996) could be the differences between the participants. Factors such as age, language studied, cultural background, and educational background could account for these differences.

There were some weaknesses in the pilot study, which were modified and improved for the present study. Firstly, as a pilot study, there were only 99 participants; however, in the present study, larger group of participants were needed. Secondly, *difficulty* and *anxiety* were investigated as quantitative variables in the pilot study; however, it would be better to conduct a qualitative study to know what the possible difficulties and anxieties are. This kind of information would be more valuable in that it tells more than numbers. Thirdly, in the pilot study, the researcher did not ask the participants to check whether they had completed all the items in the questionnaire; therefore, some of the participants' questionnaires were invalid as there were missing answers. In the present study, this

drawback was made up. Fourthly, in the pilot study, the participants completed the questionnaire without the presence of the researcher, and the teacher of the participants was the only resource if they had questions about the study or about the questionnaire. It would, however, have been better if the researcher had been present to deal with any misunderstandings of the study and the questionnaire.

By carefully going through the research design of the pilot study, which was similar to the present study, all the problematic designs in the pilot study were modified, and the weakness of the pilot study were strengthened in this study.

Participants

The participants were 178 senior high school students. They were second-grade students in a senior high school in central Taiwan. The school was chosen because it assigns the students randomly into classes. Four classes were randomly chosen—two of which were the humanities, and the others were the natural science group.

Second-grade students were chosen as the optimum students from which to elicit data. This is due to the fact that second-grade students do not have as much pressure on them as third-grade students but they have more language learning experience and are more mentally mature than first-grade students. Based on these reasons, the researcher chose the second-grade students to be the participants.

Instrumentation

Two questionnaires were employed in this study. The first questionnaire (see Appendix 1), which contained closed questions with rating scales, aimed to collect the ratings of the five variables in the current study; they were the frequency of strategy use, the degree of knowledge about a strategy, feeling it efficient, feeling it difficult to use, and feeling anxious when using it. The second questionnaire (see Appendix 2), which contained open-ended questions, aimed to collect qualitative data in the possible difficulties and

anxieties when choosing or using strategies.

The development of the two questionnaires was based on the SILL. The SILL is the strategy inventory for language learning questionnaire made by Oxford in 1989. This questionnaire, with high validity (Oxford & Burry-stock, 1995), has been adopted for the investigation of language learning strategies for the past decade. In 1992, Yang translated the SILL questionnaire into Chinese for college students. In this study (Yang, 1992), the Cronbach alphas represented the reliability is .94 with 590 participants. In 2000, Liao modified Yang's Chinese version of the SILL questionnaire for junior high school students. The Chinese version of the SILL yielded the Cronbach alphas as .96 with 473 students. The subjects in this project were senior high school students so Liao's Chinese version was preferred.

Questionnaire for Quantitative Data

The development of the quantitative questionnaire was based mainly on the questionnaire adopted in MacIntyre and Noels' study in 1996. Originally, there were fifty items (the fifty learning strategies in the SILL), and under each item, there were five sub-questions about the knowledge and efficiency of strategies, frequency of strategy use, and difficulty and anxiety in strategy use. As to the answering part, MacIntyre and Noels used seven-point likert scale to elicit answers.

The quantitative questionnaire of this study, based on the design of MacIntyre and Noels, was modified. Firstly, the questionnaire of MacIntyre and Noels was translated into Chinese. The researcher adopted Liao's translation of the fifty learning strategies, and translated the answering part into Chinese. Secondly, in order to simplify the answering procedure, the seven-point likert scale was replaced with a five-point likert scale. Thirdly, instead of placing five sub-questions under each item, the five sub-questions were arranged as five parts of the questionnaire; that is, the first part contained the questions about the

knowledge of the strategies, the second part the questions about the frequency of strategy use, the third part the efficiency of the strategies, the fourth part the anxiety when using the strategies, and the fifth the difficulty when using the strategies, respectively. The questionnaire is attached in Appendix 1. An item is exemplified in Table 3.1.

Table 3.1

The Closed Questionnaire Sample

Sample items and answering part			
Category	Sample item	Answering part	Code
Part 1 <i>Knowledge</i> (學習策略的認識)	Item 2: I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them. (我用新學的單字造句, 以加深記憶。)	1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5	1. Don't know it at all (從不知道) 5. Know it very well (知道)
Part 2 <i>Frequency</i> (學習策略的使用)	Item 5: I use rhymes to remember new English words. (我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。)	1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5	1. Never use it (從未使用) 5. Use it very often (經常使用)
Part 3 <i>Efficiency</i> (學習策略的效果)	Item 6: I use flashcards to remember new English words. (我使用單字卡來背英文生字。)	1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5	1. Consider it completely ineffective (完全無效) 5. Consider it very effective (非常有效)
Part 4 <i>Anxiety</i> (學習策略的使用感覺)	Item 7: I physically act out new English words. (我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。)	1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5	1. Feel very anxious using it (十分焦慮) 5. Not anxious about it (不會焦慮)

Part 5 <i>Difficulty</i> (學習策略的使用 難易)	Item 8: I review English lessons often. (我時常 複習英文功課。)	1 – 2 – 3 – 4 – 5	1.Very difficult to use (十分困難) 5.Very easy to use (十分簡單)
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In order to test the reliability of this quantitative questionnaire, the researcher asked fifteen second-grade senior high school students in central Taiwan to complete the questionnaire. After six days, the same fifteen students completed the questionnaire again. The test-retest reliability of this questionnaire is reported in terms of the five variables and is shown in Table 3.2. For the variable of strategy use frequency, the reliability coefficient is 0.95 ($p < .01$). For the variable *knowledge*, the reliability coefficient is 0.90 ($p < .01$), the variable *effectiveness* 0.89 ($p < .01$), the variable *difficulty* 0.91 ($p < .01$), and the variable *anxiety* 0.92 ($p < .01$), respectively.

Table 3.2

The Test-retest Reliability of the Questionnaire in Terms of the Five Variables

Variables	Reliability
Strategy use frequency	.95**
<i>Knowledge</i>	.90**
<i>Effectiveness</i>	.89**
<i>Difficulty</i>	.91**
<i>Anxiety</i>	.92**

Note. ** $P < .01$.

Questionnaire for Qualitative Data

The questionnaire was different from the quantitative one as it was aimed at eliciting qualitative data. There were six parts in this qualitative questionnaire; they were memory strategies, cognitive strategies, compensation strategies, metacognitive strategies, affective

strategies, and social strategies. In each part, the researcher first introduced the strategies in each category in Chinese. The translation, as it is used in the questionnaire for quantitative data, was the version of Liao's in 2000.

After the introduction, two open-ended questions followed. The first one was "Please choose two strategies that you have difficulties with when using, and give examples to illustrate the difficulties." The second one was "Please choose two strategies that will make you feel anxious when using, and give examples to show what kind of anxieties it is and the reason why you feel anxious." The questionnaire is attached in Appendix 2, and an example is shown in Table 3.3.

Table 3.3

The Open-ended Questionnaire Sample

Sample items and questions (Part 3)	
Sample item	Questions
1. To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses. (遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。)	1. Please choose two strategies (write down the number) that you have difficulties with when using, and give examples to illustrate the difficulties
2. When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures. (在英文對話時，如果突然有一個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。)	2. Please choose two strategies (write down the number) that will make you feel anxious when using, and give examples to show what kind of anxieties it is and the reason why you feel anxious.
3. I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English. (當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。)	
4. I read English without looking up every new word. (讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。)	
5. I try to guess what the other person will say next in English. (我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。)	
6. If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing. (當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。)	

Data Collection

The time to complete the two questionnaires was 100 minutes. Before the administration of the questionnaires, the researcher first explained the nature and the purpose of the study, gave clear instructions, and showed the participants the format of the questionnaire and the way to present their answers. The researcher also assured confidentiality, and encouraged honest answers by expressing appreciation and offering

incentives. During the administration, the researcher was in the classroom to clear up any misunderstandings for the participants. After the students completed the questionnaires, the researcher asked the students to recheck the questionnaires to ensure that there were no missing answers.

Data Analysis

Procedure for Quantitative Data Analysis

The statistical package used to analyze the quantitative data was SPSS (version 10.0), and the statistical procedure employed to analyze data was multiple regression. Multiple regression is used to investigate the relationships and the degree of association among variables. In this statistical procedure, the rating of a variable (the criterion) is predicted by the ratings of a set of variables (the predictors). Therefore, in the social-psychological model, the rating of the frequency of strategy use on each learning strategy is predicted by the ratings of the four variables, *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*.

There are various methods in multiple regression. The researcher chose stepwise multiple regression. In stepwise multiple regression, variables with best predictability are first chosen into the regression equation, and then, variables that would lower the predictability would be removed from the regression equation. This step ensures that each variable that enters the regression equation significantly contributes to the predictability.

In stepwise multiple regression, the criterion for the variables (the predictors) to enter or to be removed depends on the probability of F. In the current study, the probability of F-to-enter is $\leq .05$, and the probability of F-to-remove is $\geq .10$.

The result of a stepwise multiple regression is generally a regression equation. The adjusted R square represents the predictability of the set of the variables (the predictors), and the standardized coefficients indicate that the variables (the predictors) contribute to the predictability. In other words, the absence of the standardized coefficient of a variable

indicates that the variable does not contribute to the predictability. By examining the standardized coefficients of the variables in each strategy, the pattern of the predictors was found.

As a result, in Chapter four, the results and the discussion of the test of the social-psychological model, the researcher not only reports the adjusted R square in each strategy to show the predictability but also reports the standardized coefficients of each variable in each strategy to show whether or not the variable contribute to the prediction of the strategy.

Procedure for Quantitative Data Analysis

After collecting all the responses to the difficulties and anxieties that the participants encountered when choosing or using language learning strategies, the researcher listed the difficulties and anxieties that the participants mentioned in each learning strategy. Then, the researcher classified these difficulties and anxieties into different types of difficulties and anxieties. In Chapter Five, the results and discussion of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties, the researcher would report six main types of difficulties and three kinds of anxieties, with the language learning strategies that the participants indicated in each category. Concrete examples would be given when the results are reported.

CHAPTER FOUR

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION OF THE TEST OF THE SOCIAL-PSYCHOLOGICAL MODEL

Fifty multiple regressions were performed to test the predictability of the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) in predicting the language learning strategy choices of 178 senior high school students in Taiwan. The results are presented in the following sections, followed by detailed discussion.

Results of the Test of the Social-psychological Model

The results of the test of the social-psychological model are presented in two phases. In the first phase, the model is examined from the general view of the whole model. The focus is on the predictability of the model in predicting the participants' choices on the 50 language learning strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989). In the second phase, the predictability of the model is examined from the specific view of each of the four variables in the model. The focus is on the relationship between the frequency of strategy use and the four variables in the social-psychological model.

The Predictability of the Social-psychological Model—From the General View of the Whole Model

To test the predictability of the social-psychological model in predicting the participants' choices on strategies, stepwise multiple regressions for the 50 learning strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989) were performed. In each strategy, the frequency of strategy use was predicted by the ratings of the variables *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *anxiety*, and *difficulty*. The employment of stepwise multiple regression ensured that the four variables made significant contributions to the regression equations of the strategies predicted.

In the test of the social-psychological model, language learning strategies were predicted only if: 1) the variable *knowledge* entered the regression equation; 2) the variable

effectiveness entered the regression equation; and 3) either the variable *anxiety* or the variable *difficulty* entered the regression equations. The assumption of the social-psychological model was that a learning strategy would be used only when learners know the strategy, feel it efficient, and have no anxiety or difficulty when using it.

The results indicated that 23 items out of the 50 strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989) were predicted successfully by the social-psychological model. The predictability ranged from 36% to 75%, with an average predictability of 53 percent. It was shown that the predictability of the model in predicting learning strategies was weak. The 23 items are listed in Table 4.1, with the standardized coefficients and the adjusted R squares reported. Language learning strategies, which were not predicted by the model, were listed in Table 4.2.

Table 4.1

The Results of Regression Analyses in Predicting Strategy Use Based on the Social-psychological Model

Strategy	<i>Knowledge</i>	<i>Effectiveness</i>	<i>Anxiety</i>	<i>Difficulty</i>	Adjusted R Square
I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.	0.244	0.130	0.228	0.272	45%
I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.	0.241	0.269	0.392	--	48%
I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.	0.164	0.264	0.165	0.252	44%
I use rhymes to remember new English words.	0.242	0.335	--	0.232	42%
I use flashcards to remember new English words.	0.332	0.231	0.198	0.216	63%
I physically act out new English words.	0.336	0.273	0.243	--	49%
I try to talk like native English speakers.	0.373	0.108	0.398	0.146	69%
I practice the sounds of English.	0.478	0.175	0.321	--	62%
I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.	0.374	0.206	0.194	0.136	50%
I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.	0.227	0.306	0.154	0.271	54%
I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.	0.332	0.155	0.322	0.167	64%
I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.	0.198	0.193	0.294	0.233	48%
To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.	0.427	0.167	0.251	--	43%
When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.	0.373	0.179	0.368	--	58%
I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.	0.200	0.171	0.252	0.220	42%

I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.	0.319	0.146	0.196	0.265	55%
If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.	0.326	0.285	0.178	0.196	61%
I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.	0.213	0.237	0.239	0.156	36%
I think about my progress in learning English.	0.297	0.134	0.245	0.262	51%
I try to relax whenever I feel afraid of using English.	0.319	0.227	0.203	0.145	45%
I give myself a reward or treat when I do well in English.	0.410	0.204	0.251	--	53%
I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.	0.371	0.137	0.241	0.205	53%
I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.	0.341	0.156	0.229	0.283	75%
Average					53%

Table 4.2

The Results of Regression Analyses in Predicting Strategy Use Based on the Social-psychological Model

Strategy	<i>Knowledge</i>	<i>Effectiveness</i>	<i>Anxiety</i>	<i>Difficulty</i>	Adjusted R Square
I connect the sound of a new English word and an image or picture of the word to help me remember the word.	0.409	--	0.439	--	48%
I review English lessons often.	0.252	--	0.411	0.178	47%
I remember new English words or phrases by remembering their location on the page, on the board, or on a street sign.	0.193	--	0.317	0.301	48%
I say or write new English words several times.	0.403	--	0.261	0.249	54%
I use the English words I know in different ways.	0.276	--	0.262	0.280	38%
I start conversations in English.	0.320	--	0.278	0.272	46%
I watch English language TV shows spoken in English or go to movies spoken in English.	0.384	--	0.304	0.240	60%
I read for pleasure in English.	0.405	--	--	0.412	42%
I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.	0.173	--	0.280	0.407	49%
I try to find patterns in English.	0.329	--	0.330	0.206	50%
I try not to translate word-for-word.	0.363	--	0.255	0.267	52%
I read English without looking up every new word.	0.342	--	0.273	0.195	44%
I notice my English mistakes and use that information to help me do better.	0.405	--	0.280	0.178	49%
I pay attention when someone is speaking English.	0.510	--	--	0.326	53%

I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.	0.345	--	0.224	0.301	50%
I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.	0.201	--	0.150	0.472	45%
I look for people I can talk to in English.	0.282	--	0.185	0.337	42%
I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.	0.129	--	0.314	0.402	51%
I have clear goals for improving my English skills.	0.326	--	0.236	0.331	58%
I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.	0.393	--	0.203	0.271	53%
I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.	0.494	--	0.155	0.130	38%
I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.	0.280	--	0.338	--	28%
If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.	0.335	--	0.152	0.331	45%
I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.	0.349	--	0.212	0.228	40%
I practice English with other students.	0.181	--	0.265	0.391	48%
I ask for help from English speakers.	0.271	--	0.300	0.246	46%
I ask questions in English.	0.374	--	0.316	0.216	54%
Average					47%

The Predictability of the Social-psychological Model—From the Specific View of the Four Variables

In addition to the predictability of the social-psychological model, the researcher further examined the relationships between the frequency of strategy use and the four variables. The researcher first examined the standardized coefficients reported in Table 4.1 and Table 4.2, and then examined the correlation coefficients of the frequency of strategy use and the four variables.

By examining the standardized coefficients in Table 4.1 and Table 4.2, it was shown that the variable *effectiveness* only entered 23 equations when predicting the frequency of strategy use. In other words, the variable *effectiveness* failed to account for the variability of strategy use frequency of 27 items in the SILL. On the other hand, the variable *knowledge* entered all 50 equations, the variable *anxiety* entered 47 equations, and the variable *difficulty* entered 42 equations. It should be noticed that the variables *anxiety* and *difficulty* in the social-psychological model together served as the reasons that prevented strategies from being used; therefore, it can be said that the reasons that prevented the students from using strategies, feeling anxious and difficult when using strategies, entered all 50 cases. In other words, together with the variable *knowledge*, the variable *anxiety* and *difficulty* were also effective predictors. In Table 4.3, the numbers of items in the SILL, that the four variables in the social-psychological model predicted, are listed.

Table 4.3

Numbers of Items in the SILL that the Four Variables in Social-psychological ModelPredicted

The social-psychological model	Representing Variable	Items Predicted
Knowing the strategy	<i>knowledge</i>	50 items
Feeling the strategy effective	<i>effectiveness</i>	23 items
Having no reason not to use the strategy	<i>anxiety and difficulty</i>	50 items
		<i>anxiety, 47 items</i>
		<i>difficulty, 42 items</i>

The examination of the correlation coefficients indicated that there were significant correlations between the frequency of strategy use and the four social-psychological variables. The correlation coefficients of the frequency of strategy use and the four variables of each learning strategy in the SILL are reported in Table 4.4.

Table 4.4

The Correlation Coefficients between the Four Variables and the Variable Frequency

Strategy	<i>Knowledge</i>	<i>Effectiveness</i>	<i>Anxiety</i>	<i>Difficulty</i>
I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.	0.51**	0.44**	0.56**	0.58**
I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.	0.48**	0.51**	0.59**	0.55**
I connect the sound of a new English word and an image or picture of the word to help me remember the word.	0.56**	0.43**	0.58**	0.47**
I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.	0.45**	0.56**	0.51**	0.56**
I use rhymes to remember new English words.	0.50**	0.58**	0.51**	0.51**
I use flashcards to remember new English words.	0.65**	0.64**	0.68**	0.65**
I physically act out new English words.	0.60**	0.59**	0.57**	0.45**
I review English lessons often.	0.52**	0.31**	0.63**	0.52**
I remember new English words or phrases by remembering their location on the page, on the board, or on a street sign.	0.55**	0.47**	0.62**	0.63**
I say or write new English words several times.	0.63**	0.36**	0.59**	0.55**
I try to talk like native English speakers.	0.68**	0.52**	0.74**	0.59**
I practice the sounds of English.	0.70**	0.48**	0.64**	0.49**
I use the English words I know in different ways.	0.42**	0.41**	0.49**	0.51**
I start conversations in English.	0.52**	0.45**	0.57**	0.53**
I watch English language TV shows spoken in English or go to movies spoken in English.	0.67**	0.34**	0.65**	0.64**

I read for pleasure in English.	0.52**	0.26**	0.46**	0.52**
I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.	0.47**	0.31**	0.58**	0.63**
I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.	0.64**	0.49**	0.56**	0.47**
I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.	0.55**	0.60**	0.55**	0.58**
I try to find patterns in English.	0.59**	0.38**	0.60**	0.56**
I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.	0.67**	0.62**	0.72**	0.62**
I try not to translate word-for-word.	0.61**	0.45**	0.58**	0.59**
I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.	0.51**	0.44**	0.59**	0.57**
To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.	0.57**	0.43**	0.48**	0.34**
When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.	0.65**	0.55**	0.66**	0.50**
I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.	0.46**	0.49**	0.56**	0.52**
I read English without looking up every new word.	0.56**	0.45**	0.56**	0.51**
I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.	0.60**	0.56**	0.63**	0.61**
If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.	0.66**	0.66**	0.53**	0.63**
I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.	0.45**	0.45**	0.46**	0.42**
I notice my English mistakes and use that information to help me do better.	0.61**	0.46**	0.55**	0.52**
I pay attention when someone is speaking English.	0.68**	0.48**	0.59**	0.59**
I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.	0.59**	0.45**	0.56**	0.59**
I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.	0.42**	0.25**	0.50**	0.63**
I look for people I can talk to in English.	0.51**	0.19*	0.52**	0.57**
I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.	0.48**	0.22**	0.62**	0.66**
I have clear goals for improving my English skills.	0.65**	0.36**	0.65**	0.67**

I think about my progress in learning English.	0.58**	0.42**	0.60**	0.57**
I try to relax whenever I feel afraid of using English.	0.55**	0.46**	0.52**	0.49**
I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.	0.65**	0.33**	0.57**	0.61**
I give myself a reward or treat when I do well in English.	0.64**	0.59**	0.59**	0.51**
I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.	0.59**	0.40**	0.41**	0.31**
I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.	0.44**	0.35**	0.47**	0.38**
I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.	0.60**	0.43**	0.62**	0.53**
If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.	0.56**	0.42**	0.51**	0.58**
I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.	0.54**	0.35**	0.49**	0.52**
I practice English with other students.	0.46**	0.36**	0.60**	0.64**
I ask for help from English speakers.	0.54**	0.22**	0.60**	0.58**
I ask questions in English.	0.60**	0.39**	0.64**	0.57**
I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.	0.76**	0.65**	0.78**	0.76**
Average	0.57	0.44	0.58	0.55

Note. * P<.05. ** P<.01.

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From the numbers of items that the four variables predicted, and the correlation coefficients of the frequency of strategy use for the four variables, it was shown that the relationship between the frequency of strategy use and the four variables was significant. The average correlation coefficient of the frequency of strategy use for the variable *knowledge* was 0.57, the variable *effectiveness*, 0.44, the variable *anxiety*, 0.58, and the variable *difficulty*, 0.55, respectively. The average correlation coefficient of the frequency of strategy use for the variable *effectiveness* was 0.44, which is the lowest among the four variables. This result was consistent with the results of the multiple regression in testing the predictability of the social-psychological model, which indicated that the predictability of the variable *effectiveness* is not as good as the other three variables: *knowledge*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*.

Discussion of the Results in the Test of the Model

In the test of the social-psychological model, there are two major findings. Firstly, the predictability of the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) was relatively weak. Secondly, although the predictability of the whole model was relatively weak, the four social-psychological variables were all significantly related with the frequency of strategy use.

The Predictability of the Social-psychological Model

When predicting the strategy choices of senior high school students in Taiwan, the social-psychological model predicted 23 items of the language learning strategies in the SILL, with an average predictability of 53%. While the model showed relatively weak predictability of language learning strategies in the current study, it showed stronger predictability in MacIntyre and Noels' study (1996), when being applied to 138 first-grade college students. In that study, the model predicted 35 items in the SILL, with an average predictability of 60 percent. Possible explanations of the discrepancy between the two studies could be, firstly, the representing variables for testing the social-psychological model, and, secondly, the differences between the background of the two groups of participants.

The representing variables in the model

The weak predictability of the social-psychological model might result from the variables that were chosen and submitted to the test of the model with senior high school students. When the model was proposed by MacIntyre in 1994, there were four considerations. Each consideration included several variables. For example, attained proficiency, aptitude intelligence and situational demands were included in the first consideration, awareness of an appropriate strategy. Attitude, motivation, previous success and effectiveness were the variables represented the second consideration, reasons to use a strategy. In the third consideration, reasons not to use a strategy, there were variables such

as anxiety, self confidence and sanctions against the strategy. Positive consequences were then the fourth consideration to reinforce the strategy use.

However, when testing the model in the current study, only one or two variables were chosen from each consideration and submitted to the test of the predictability. For example, the four variables chosen in the current study were *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty* and *anxiety*. The variable *knowledge* represented the first consideration in the model, the awareness of appropriate strategies. The variable *effectiveness* represented the second consideration, the reason to use a strategy. The variables *difficulty* and *anxiety* served as the reasons not to use a strategy, which is the third consideration.

While there were other variables in the social-psychological model, it is subjective to choose only one or two from each consideration to test the predictability of the model. It would be possible that, in the current study, the strategy choices of the participants were related to variables other than the four ones that were chosen in the test. As was reported in the result of the current study, though the four variables, *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *difficulty* and *anxiety*, were significantly related to the frequency of strategy use, the correlation coefficients were not high. On the other hand, the variable, attained proficiency, in the first consideration and the variable, motivation, in the second consideration were both reported as variables related to the strategy choices of senior high school students (Ku, 1995). However, these variables were not submitted to the test of the predictability of the model. It would be possible that the missing of these variables in the test of the model resulted in the weak predictability in the current study.

The differences between the two groups of participants

The different predictabilities of the social-psychological model in the current study and the study of MacIntyre and Noels (1996) might result from the different background of the participants. The two groups of participants were different in their age, national origin,

learning environment, and the target language studied. The different background of the two groups could indirectly affect the predictability of the model.

The participants in MacIntyre and Noels' study in 1996 were 138 first-year EFL students in the Modern Languages Department of a university. The age of the participants in MacIntyre and Noels' study (1996) ranged from 17 to 52 years old, with an average age of 22.2 years. However, in the current study, the participants were 178 senior high school students, with an average age of 17. As was reported, age influences learners' strategy choices (Yang, 1994; Yutaka, 1997). Therefore, it may be possible that the difference in the results of these two studies exists as a result of the age difference of the participants.

The participants of the two groups studied different languages. The participants in the study of MacIntyre and Noels (1996) were the learners of Spanish and Italian, but the participants of the current study were the learners of English. In 2000, Wharton pointed out that the choices of learning strategies were influenced by the degree of cognateness between the native language and the foreign languages (p.208). The participants in the study of MacIntyre and Noels had learned English for years. English shares many similarities with Spanish and Italian. Therefore, it might be easier for the participants of MacIntyre and Noels to apply language learning strategies to the study of their target languages. On the other hand, the native languages of the participants in the present study, Chinese and Taiwanese, share few similarities with the target language, English. Therefore, it may also be possible that the difference in the results of these studies is due to the different languages being studied by the participants.

Although the two groups of participants were all foreign language learners, the two groups of participants shared different cultural and educational backgrounds. As was reported by Yutaka (1997) and Sheorey (1999), cultural and educational backgrounds were also the factors that might influence the choices of strategies. Therefore, another factor that

produced different results for these two studies could be the cultural and educational backgrounds of the participants.

From the discussion above, we know that aside from the variables included in the social psychological model proposed by MacIntyre (1994), there might be a lot of different variables affecting strategy use, such as age, language studied, and cultural and educational background. These variables possibly affected the strategy choices of the participants directly, and affected the predictability of the model indirectly.

In addition, from the literature review of the studies investigating the strategy choices of senior high school students in Taiwan, it was reported that possible factors influencing strategy use include learning style and English learning aptitude (Yang, 1991), achievement (Yang, 1993), gender (Yang, 1991; Ku, 1995), and language learning beliefs (Huang, 1997) amongst others. In short, there are still a large number of unexplored factors affecting language learning strategy choices.

Significant Relationship Between the Frequency of Strategy Use and the Four Variables

By examining the standardized coefficients in all equations, we know that the variable *knowledge* entered all equations, a fact which meant that the variable *knowledge* was a good predictor in predicting language learning strategy choices. Also, the variable *anxiety* entered 47 equations, and the variable *difficulty* entered 42 equations. Therefore, both *anxiety* and *difficulty* were good predictors.

On the other hand, examining the failure of the 27 items, which were not predicted by the model, the researcher found that the failure was related to the variable *effectiveness*, which did not enter regression equations. However, the failure didn't mean that the variable *effectiveness* had nothing to do with the frequency of strategy use. Instead, the results only showed that the predictability of the variable *effectiveness* was weaker than that of the other variables in the equations. The reason was that the researcher employed stepwise multiple

regression to examine the predictability of the model, which first chose better predictors into the equation, and then removed the weaker ones that would decrease the predictability of the model. Therefore, we can only suspect that the relationship between the variable *effectiveness* and the frequency of strategy use was weaker than that of the other variables.

The results indicated that the variables *knowledge*, *anxiety*, and *difficulty* were good predictors but the variable *effectiveness* was not. This was consistent with the results of the correlation coefficients of the frequency of strategy use and the four variables. The results of the correlation coefficients showed that the four variables were all significantly related to the frequency of strategy use, and that the variable *effectiveness* had the lowest correlation coefficient among the four. As a result, we can conclude that the four variables all significantly related with the frequency of strategy use, but the relationship between the variable *effectiveness* and the frequency of strategy use was weaker than that of the other variables: *knowledge*, *difficulty*, and *anxiety*.

Brief Summary

In the current study, the test of the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994) was aimed at finding whether the model served as a good predictor of language learning strategy choices when applied to senior high school students in Taiwan. The results indicated that the predictability of the model in predicting learning strategy use frequency was weak; it predicted 23 learning strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989), with an average predictability of 53 percent. The weak predictability of the model might suggest the insufficiency of the variables chosen from the model for testing the predictability with senior high school students. Another possible explanation for the weak predictability was the existence of other variables in predicting learning strategy choices, such as age, language studied, cultural background, and educational background. The results also indicated that the four variables in the model were all significantly related with learning strategy use

frequency. Therefore, we can conclude that knowing a strategy, feeling it efficient, and having no anxiety or difficulty when using it were related with language learning strategy choices.

CHAPTER FIVE

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION OF THE INVESTIGATION OF DIFFICULTIES AND ANXIETIES

In the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994), both the variables *difficulty* and *anxiety* served as the main reasons that prevented learners from using language learning strategies. The results of testing this model in the current study showed that the two variables together predicted the frequency of strategy use of all items in the SILL, and were significantly related to the frequency of strategy use.

In order to discover the manner in which the two variables influenced the participants' choices on learning strategies, the researcher investigated the possible difficulties and anxieties that the students encountered when choosing or using language learning strategies. From 178 open-ended questionnaires, the researcher classified various types of difficulties and anxieties that hindered the participants from choosing or using certain learning strategies. The following sections fall into two parts, firstly, the results of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties and, secondly, the detailed discussion of major findings respectively.

Results of the Investigation of Difficulties and Anxieties

The results are reported in two parts. Six types of difficulties for the participants in choosing or using language learning strategies are presented first. In the second part, various types of anxieties in choosing or using learning strategies are reported.

Difficulties

The researcher classified six types of difficulties encountered by the participants when choosing or using language learning strategies. They were the unfamiliarity of language learning strategies, the requirement of English ability, the EFL language learning environment, the feeling of being embarrassed, the passive learning attitude, and the heavy academic load from school.

The unfamiliarity of language learning strategies

The unfamiliarity of language learning strategies was an obstacle that prevented the participants from choosing or using certain learning strategies. The participants reported that they had this difficulty when using 33 items in the SILL. These items are listed in Table 5.1.

Table 5.1

Category 1: The Unfamiliarity of the Language Learning Strategies

Item	Description
1	I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
3	I connect the sound of a new English word and an image or picture of the word to help me remember the word.
4	I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.
7	I physically act out new English words.
13	I use the English words I know in different ways.
14	I start conversations in English.
18	I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
19	I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
20	I try to find patterns in English.
21	I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
22	I try not to translate word-for-word.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
24	To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.
25	When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
26	I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
27	I read English without looking up every new word.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
31	I notice my English mistakes and use that information to help me do better.
33	I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.
34	I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.

36	I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.
37	I have clear goals for improving my English skills.
38	I think about my progress in learning English.
39	I try to relax whenever I feel afraid of using English.
40	I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.
41	I give myself a reward or treat when I do well in English.
42	I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.
43	I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
50	I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.

The participants seemed not to choose or use a language learning strategy if they were not familiar with it. For example, when referring to the compensation strategy, “Try to guess what the other person will say next in English”, the participants reported that they did not know the reason for or the way to make such a guess. It seemed unreasonable for the participants to guess what the other person would say next in English. The participants wondered, “...why should we make guesses?” and “...does it have anything to do with learning English?” Besides, it seemed impossible for the participants to guess what the other person would say next in English. One student reported that “...how could we know what he or she will say next in English?” Other students also reported, “...is it possible to make such a guess? How could that happen?” and “...how do I know the way to make a guess...”

The same situation took place when referring to the strategy, “Make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English”. One of the students reported that “... How can I make up new words? If I can make up new words, then I don’t need to learn English...” The students also reported that they were not good at using this strategy. As it was reported, the participants admitted that they were “not creative, and do not have such an imagination to make up new words.” Another example was the strategy, “Write down my feelings in a

language learning diary”. Some students reported that they don’t know what a language learning diary is, and they did not know what they should write in the diary.

The requirement of English ability

The participants seemed to believe that the application of learning strategies requires good English ability. The participants pointed out this difficulty when using the learning strategies listed in Table 5.2. For example, the students reported that their English was not good enough to “Write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English”. It seemed that, with a small vocabulary bank and a limited knowledge of sentence structures, the participants were afraid that they could not express themselves well. Another example was the strategy, “Start conversations in English”. The students reported that even if they started the conversation, with their poor English, it was impossible for them to continue the conversation. For instance, one student reported that the conversation would be “Hello!”, and then, “....”

Table 5.2

Category 2: The Requirement of English Ability

Item	Description
1	I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
5	I use rhymes to remember new English words.
11	I try to talk like native English speakers.
14	I start conversations in English.
15	I watch English language TV shows spoken in English or go to movies spoken in English.
16	I read for pleasure in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
18	I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
19	I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
20	I try to find patterns in English.

21	I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
22	I try not to translate word-for-word.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
24	To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.
27	I read English without looking up every new word.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
29	If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.
31	I notice my English mistakes and use that information to help me do better.
32	I pay attention when someone is speaking English.
36	I look for people I can talk to in English.
41	I give myself a reward or treat when I do well in English.
45	If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

Another example was the strategy, “Try to guess what the other person will say next in English”. The participants seemed to believe that, because of their poor English, it was not possible for them to use this strategy. As it was reported by one student, “...I can only concentrate on listening and giving responses. If I made a guess, I would miss lots of what was said by other.” There were also students who wrote, “...my listening comprehension is poor, how can I make guesses if I don't understand what he says....”

The awareness that they were not good at English hindered the participants' use of certain language learning strategies, such as, “Start conversations in English” and “Practice English with other students”. The students reported that their English was not accurate and fluent, and their pronunciation was not standard. They worried that they would make mistakes, and that others would correct them or mock them.

The EFL language learning environment

The EFL language learning environment was another difficulty encountered by the participants when using language learning strategies. This difficulty was pointed out when using strategies listed in Table 5.3. It seemed difficult to use certain language learning strategies in an EFL language learning environment, for example, “Ask for help from English speakers”. The students reported that it was difficult for them to meet ‘English speakers’. As one student wrote, “There are not so many ‘English speakers’ around me and I don’t have friends who are native speakers.”

Table 5.3

Category 3: The EFL Language Learning Environment

Item	Description
11	I try to talk like native English speakers.
14	I start conversations in English.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
32	I pay attention when someone is speaking English.
35	I look for people I can talk to in English.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.
50	I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.

The same situation took place when the participants were asked to apply strategies such as, “Practice English with other students” and “Start conversations in English”. In an EFL learning environment, it seemed that the students seldom practiced English or started a conversation in English. As it was reported by one student, “...it seems not possible that others would practice English with me.” There were also students who wrote statements,

such as, "...all people around me speak Chinese...."

The feeling of being embarrassed

The feeling of being embarrassed was another difficulty that intimidated the participant's use of certain language learning strategies. The participants pointed out this difficulty when using learning strategies listed in Table 5.4.

Table 5.4

Category 4: The Feeling of Being Embarrassed

Item	Description
7	I physically act out new English words.
11	I try to talk like native English speakers.
14	I start conversations in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
25	When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
26	I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
35	I look for people I can talk to in English.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
45	If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

It seemed embarrassing for the students to use strategies such as, "Physically act out new English words", "Talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English", and "Ask questions in English". The students reported, "...it is embarrassing to act out the word...to share feelings with others...and to ask questions." In addition, using the strategy,

“Ask for help from English speakers”, was also embarrassing. One student wrote, “...it is embarrassing if others don’t understand what I am talking about or if they feel troublesome in helping me.”

The passive learning attitude

The passive learning attitude of the participants was another difficulty encountered when applying certain strategies. The participants reported that they would not use certain strategies unless they were asked to. These strategies are listed in Table 5.5.

Table 5.5

Category 5: The Passive Attitude

Item	Description
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
8	I review English lessons often.
14	I start conversations in English.
16	I read for pleasure in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
18	I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
20	I try to find patterns in English.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
32	I pay attention when someone is speaking English.
33	I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.
34	I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.
35	I look for people I can talk to in English.
36	I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.
37	I have clear goals for improving my English skills.
43	I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.
47	I practice English with other students.
49	I ask questions in English.
50	I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.

Some learning strategies require learners' efforts, such as, "Use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them", "Try to find patterns in English", and "Make summaries of information that I hear or read in English". It seemed that the participants were generally reluctant to use these strategies. The students reported that "...it is troublesome to do this; it is more convenient to read examples in textbook and grammars in reference books...." The same was true when using strategies like "Write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English". One student wrote, "I'd like to write reports in Chinese so I don't need to look up the dictionary often and I can express myself well." All these statements provided evidenced of the passive learning attitude of the participants when using language learning strategies.

The heavy academic load from school

The last difficulty that stopped the participants from applying certain language learning strategies was the heavy academic load from school. This difficulty was pointed out especially when the participants use strategies listed in Table 5.6.

Table 5.6

Category 6: The heavy academic load from school

Item	Description
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
6	I use flashcards to remember new English words.
8	I review English lessons often.
10	I say or write new English words several times.
15	I watch English language TV shows spoken in English or go to movies spoken in English.
16	I read for pleasure in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
18	I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
20	I try to find patterns in English.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.

30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
34	I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.
35	I look for people I can talk to in English.
36	I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.
38	I think about my progress in learning English.
43	I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
50	I try to learn about the culture of English speakers.

There were students who complained about the heavy academic load from school that prevented them from using certain strategies. For example, when referring to the strategy, “Write down my feelings in a language learning diary”, one student reported, “... if I had time, I would spend it on studying English or on other subjects.” The same situation took place when referring to the strategies such as, “I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them” and “I try to learn about the culture of English speakers”. The students reported that “there are more than twenty new words in each lesson, it takes time to make sentences...”, and “I have no time to learn about the culture of English speakers”. It seemed that under the pressure of time limitation resulting from the heavy academic load, the students would choose strategies that would not be too time consuming.

Anxieties

From the students’ various responses about the anxieties raised when applying language learning strategies, the researcher classified three main types of anxieties. These three main types are reported in the following section. They were the anxiety that would happen before, during, and after the application of language learning strategies.

Anxiety raised before the application of learning strategies

Before using certain strategies, the participants seemed to worry that they would make mistakes or embarrass themselves. It was reported that this could happen when using learning strategies listed in Table 5.7.

Table 5.7

Category 1: Anxiety raised before the application of strategies

The fear of making mistakes	
Item	Description
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
4	I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.
5	I use rhymes to remember new English words.
13	I use the English words I know in different ways.
14	I start conversations in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
18	I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
19	I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
20	I try to find patterns in English.
21	I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
22	I try not to translate word-for-word.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
24	To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.
25	When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
26	I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
27	I read English without looking up every new word.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
29	If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
40	I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.
42	I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.

47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

The fear of embarrassing oneself	
Item	Description
7	I physically act out new English words.
11	I try to talk like native English speakers.
12	I practice the sounds of English.
14	I start conversations in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
25	When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
26	I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
35	I look for people I can talk to in English.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
45	If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

For example, when using some strategies, such as the cognitive strategy, “Start conversations in English”, the fear of making mistakes made the participants very anxious. The students reported that “My pronunciation and grammar are poor; there must be a lot of mistakes.” The same situation would occur when the students used the strategy, “Use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them”. The students reported that they believed that the sentences they made could be wrong, but the example sentences in the textbook must be right. So it would be better to remember the example sentences in the textbook.

Moreover, learning strategies that require the cooperation with other classmates also seemed to make the students feel anxious before using them. There seemed to be lots of considerations before choosing these strategies. For example, the students reported, "...it would be embarrassing to talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English." There were students who reported "...if I share my feelings with my classmates, they would know my strength and weakness. I don't want them to know that." The participants also worried about using the strategy, "Practice English with other students". The students reported that "...everyone talks in Chinese; it would be strange to speak English." There were also students who wrote, "...it would be embarrassing to speak poor English...."

Anxiety raised during the application of learning strategies

The participants seemed to become anxious if they felt confused during the period of time spent applying certain strategies. Additionally, the participants seemed anxious if they made mistakes or felt embarrassed when applying language learning strategies. Learning strategies that would raise anxiety of this kind are listed in Table 5.8.

Table 5.8

Category 2: Anxiety raised during the application of strategies

The confusion resulted from the application of strategies	
Item	Description
1	I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
3	I connect the sound of a new English word and an image or picture of the word to help me remember the word.
4	I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.
5	I use rhymes to remember new English words.
9	I remember new English words or phrases by remembering their location on the page, on the board, or on a street sign.

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- 11 I try to talk like native English speakers.
 - 13 I use the English words I know in different ways.
 - 14 I start conversations in English.
 - 17 I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
 - 18 I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
 - 19 I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
 - 20 I try to find patterns in English.
 - 21 I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
 - 22 I try not to translate word-for-word.
 - 24 To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.
 - 25 When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
 - 26 I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
 - 27 I read English without looking up every new word.
 - 28 I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
 - 29 If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.
 - 30 I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
 - 32 I pay attention when someone is speaking English.
 - 33 I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.
 - 37 I have clear goals for improving my English skills.
 - 44 I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
-

The fact of making mistakes or embarrassing oneself

Item	Description
5	I use rhymes to remember new English words.
7	I physically act out new English words.
11	I try to talk like native English speakers.
12	I practice the sounds of English.
13	I use the English words I know in different ways.
14	I start conversations in English.
17	I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
19	I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
20	I try to find patterns in English.
21	I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
22	I try not to translate word-for-word.
23	I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
24	To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.

25	When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
26	I make up new words if I do not know the right ones in English.
27	I read English without looking up every new word.
28	I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
29	If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.
30	I try to find as many ways as I can to use my English.
39	I try to relax whenever I feel afraid of using English.
40	I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.
42	I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.
44	I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
45	If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

There are strategies involving guessing, such as the strategy, "To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses". It seemed that when encountering unfamiliar words, the students could not help but look up the words in the dictionary. The students reported that "...I want to know the word's meaning immediately, or I can't keep on reading the rest of the article." It seemed that the participants wanted the correct answer immediately and avoid the feeling of uncertainty that seemed to make them very anxious. The same situation took place when the students referred to the strategy, "I use rhymes to remember new English words". The students reported that they would be confused if there are too many words share similar rhymes.

It seemed the fact that the students made mistakes raised anxiety during the application of language learning strategies. The students reported that the anxiety would appear when they used some strategies such as, "Start conversations in English", "Write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English", "To understand unfamiliar English words, I make

guesses”, “When I can’t think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures”, “Practice English with other students”, and “If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again”. The students reported that when they made mistakes in pronunciation, in grammar, or when others could not understand them, they would feel embarrassed and would be very nervous.

When referring to the strategy, “Ask English speakers to correct me when I talk”, it was reported that the students would feel nervous when being corrected. Another example, that would cause anxiety during the application of language learning strategies, was the use of the affective strategies, such as, “Notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English” and “Try to relax whenever I feel afraid of using English”. The students reported that “...it is hard to relax...” and “...I would be more anxious if I pay attention to my nervous feeling...”

Anxiety raised after the application of learning strategies

After using learning strategies, the students would be anxious and embarrassed if the strategies were not applied successfully. The participants seemed to judge themselves negatively if they failed to apply language learning strategies successfully. This anxiety would happen especially when the strategies listed in Table 5.9 are used.

Table 5.9

Category 3: Anxiety raised after the application of strategies

The negative judgment about oneself	
Item	Description
1	I think of relationships between what I already know and new things I learn in English.
2	I use new English words in a sentence so I can remember them.
3	I connect the sound of a new English word and an image or picture of the word to help me remember the word.

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- 4 I remember a new English word by making a mental picture of a situation on which the word might be used.
- 5 I use rhymes to remember new English words.
- 6 I use flashcards to remember new English words.
- 11 I try to talk like native English speakers.
- 12 I practice the sounds of English.
- 13 I use the English words I know in different ways.
- 14 I start conversations in English.
- 15 I watch English language TV shows spoken in English or go to movies spoken in English.
- 16 I read for pleasure in English.
- 17 I write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English.
- 18 I first skim an English passage (read over the passage quickly) then go back and read carefully.
- 19 I look for words in my own language that are similar to new words in English.
- 20 I try to find patterns in English.
- 21 I find the meaning of an English word by dividing it into parts that I understand.
- 22 I try not to translate word-for-word.
- 23 I make summaries of information that I hear or read in English.
- 24 To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses.
- 25 When I can't think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures.
- 27 I read English without looking up every new word.
- 28 I try to guess what the other person will say next in English.
- 29 If I can't think of an English word, I use a word or phrase that means the same thing.
- 31 I notice my English mistakes and use that information to help me do better.
- 32 I pay attention when someone is speaking English.
- 33 I try to find out how to be a better learner of English.
- 34 I plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English.
- 35 I look for people I can talk to in English.
- 36 I look for opportunities to read as much as possible in English.
- 37 I have clear goals for improving my English skills.
- 38 I think about my progress in learning English.
- 40 I encourage myself to speak English even when I am afraid of making a mistake.
- 41 I give myself a reward or treat when I do well in English.
- 42 I notice if I am tense or nervous when I am studying or using English.
- 43 I write down my feelings in a language learning diary.
- 44 I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English.
-

45	If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again.
46	I ask English speakers to correct me when I talk.
47	I practice English with other students.
48	I ask for help from English speakers.
49	I ask questions in English.

Anxieties took place after using the strategies, “To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses”, and “When I can’t think of a word during a conversation in English, I use gestures,” as in compensation strategies. The fact that they needed to make guesses and use gestures meant that the students could not express themselves well. Also, the fact that their English was so poor that they could not continue the conversation appeared to make the participants anxious. Guessing and making gestures seemed to make the students underestimate their English ability so that anxieties appeared unavoidable.

The participants seemed to attribute failures to their poor English ability, and this awareness made them disappointed and anxious. For example, if the students failed to “Start conversations in English”, made mistakes when attempting to “Write notes, messages, letters, or reports in English”, or “Practice English with other students”, they would be anxious. When referring the application of the strategy, “If I do not understand something in English, I ask the other person to slow down or say it again”, one student reported that “...the other person can’t understand what I am talking about because I can’t express myself well. I worry about my poor English.”

It seemed that the negative effects of applying learning strategies made the students anxious as well. For example, when referring to the strategy, “Pay attention when someone is speaking English”, one student reported that, “...after I listen to others, I found that my listening is really bad.” Also, after using strategies, such as, “Think about my progress in learning English”, “Write down my feelings in a language learning diary”, and “Have clear

goals for improving my English”, some students wrote, “...what I write down in my diary were bad feelings...I didn’t make any progress,” and “...I can’t find my goal in learning English.” The same situation was reported after using the strategy, “Ask English speakers to correct me when I talk”. One student reported, “I had been corrected all the time, it was really embarrassing.” It seemed that those negative feelings made the participants worry about their learning.

Discussion of the Investigation of Difficulties and Anxieties

The results of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties when the participants used language learning strategies indicated the existence of six types of difficulties and three kinds of anxieties. What follows is the discussion about them.

Difficulties

The unfamiliarity of language learning strategies

The results of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties showed that the students tended not to use strategies they were not quite familiar with. The students would not use strategies they did not know, and they would not use strategies they did not have a reason to use. The results also showed that the participants would not use strategies that they did not know how to use or when to use. This finding was consistent with the assumption in the social-psychological model proposed by MacIntyre in 1994. This finding was also evidenced of the results reported in Chapter four of the current study, the results and discussion of the test of the social-psychological model, that the variable, *knowledge*, was an effective predictor. That is, students tended to use a strategy they both knew well and knew when, why and how to use.

The requirement of English ability

The students seemed to believe that if they wanted to use some strategies, their English needed to be good. This difficulty might come from the students' misunderstanding about the reasons for using language learning strategies. Defined by Oxford (1990), language learning strategies are "steps taken by students to enhance their own learning" (p. 1). Learners are supposed to use these learning strategies to enhance their English proficiency. However, it seemed that the students were confused with the reasons in using learning strategies, and regarded "being proficient in English" as the requirement of using strategies. This misunderstanding that they needed to be proficient in English to use learning strategies obviously affected the participants' motivation when applying learning strategies.

The EFL language learning environment

Some learning strategies are used to encourage learners to talk to native English speakers, to start conversations in English, to ask for the help of foreigners, and to practice English. However, in Taiwan, the EFL learning environment could be an obstacle that impedes learners' application of language learning strategies. As was reported by the participants in the current study, there were not many opportunities for learners to talk to native speakers or to practice English with others. The disadvantage of the EFL language learning environment had also been pointed out by other researchers (Yang, 1993; Huang, 1997; Teng, 1998; Wharton, 2000). The participants in Huang's study (1997) also pointed out that one of the reasons that students seldom speak English to others was "the lack of an environment to practice English with classmates or friends" (p. 141). Therefore, the difficulty for the students to find opportunities to practice English made the EFL learning environment one of the factors that impeded learning strategy use.

The feeling of being embarrassed

The participants in the current study reported that the application of certain learning strategies embarrassed them. The students felt embarrassed to speak English, to act out physically, to share feelings with others, to ask questions of others, or to ask for the help from others. When responding to the questions about the difficulties of using learning strategies, the participants seemed to express their concerns about losing face, making fools of themselves, or being mocked by others. The same concerns were also pointed out by the participants in Yang's study (1993, p. 201). Also, in Huang's study (1997), seventy percent of interviewees "never or seldom used English in daily life" because of the fear of presumed troubles such as "misunderstanding, embarrassment, or other difficulties" (p. 131). The feeling of being embarrassed thus stopped the students from using certain language learning strategies.

The passive learning attitude

The application of certain language learning strategies may require learners' effort. Strategies such as making new sentences, finding sentence patterns, using new words in many ways, writing summaries, and finding opportunities to practice English all require the learners' effort. The difficulty when using these strategies was the learners' passive learning attitude. In 1998, Teng investigated the listening comprehension strategies of college students. Teng reported that "Taiwanese students' learning style tends to be passive and unreflecting", and that the learning style influences students' choices of learning strategies (p. 12). Teng also pointed out that strategies such as, "Writing a language learning diary", and "Planning for a language task", were the strategies least frequently used. The two strategies were also on the list of strategies that the students would not use if they were not asked to. The passive learning attitude thus became a difficulty that stopped the students from using certain learning strategies.

The heavy academic load from school

The heavy academic load from school was another difficulty that prevented learners from applying certain learning strategies. It seemed that the students tended not to use strategies that would take them too much time, or strategies which would not help their studying immediately. Strategies such as, “I try to learn about the culture of English speakers”, “I write down my feelings in a language learning diary”, and “I talk to someone else about how I feel when I am learning English”, all fell into this category.

The students complained about the heavy academic load from school. When referring to the strategy, “Plan my schedule so I will have enough time to study English”, the students reported, “there are lots of exams; all I have to do is follow the schedule full of these exams.” There were also students who wrote, “...there are always lots of chores that would suddenly interrupt my schedule” and “I always forget to do it.” It seemed that the students failed to arrange their time well and failed to use these learning strategies to help their studying and reduce the heavy academic load.

Anxieties

From the results of the investigation of anxieties, it was reported that anxieties could be raised before, during, and after the application of learning strategies. Before using language learning strategies, the participants seemed to worry a lot because of their fear of making mistakes and getting embarrassed. During the application of language learning strategies, the feeling of uncertainty, the making of mistakes and getting embarrassed all made the participants anxious. After the application of language learning strategies, the negative feelings and self-judgments resulting from the failure of strategy applications also made the students anxious.

Anxiety raised before applying the language learning strategies

Factors that would raise anxieties may result from the inadequate language learning beliefs of the students. For example, the students seemed to believe that it would be better for learners not to speak English unless they could speak it correctly and with excellent pronunciation. The existence of a learning belief of this kind was also pointed out by studies investigating language learning beliefs, such as Yang's study (1993), and Huang's study (1997). Due to such language learning beliefs, when referring the application of language learning strategies, the students worried that they would make mistakes, which would make them feel embarrassed.

Experience of unsuccessful application of language learning strategies could be another reason that the participants feared to make mistakes and embarrass themselves. As was pointed out by MacIntyre in 1994, strategy use should be reinforced by positive consequence and previous success was one of the reasons for learners to use strategies. Unsuccessful strategy-application experience may make the students lose their confidence and may make the students question their English ability. As a result, the students may feel afraid of using the same learning strategies again.

Anxiety raised during the application of the language learning strategies

Inadequate language learning beliefs not only resulted in the fear of making mistakes before the application of learning strategies, but also resulted in the anxiety during the application of strategies. It was reported in Huang's study (1997) that senior high school students in Taiwan view accuracy as the priority in school learning (p. 181). Although this language learning belief is inadequate, it seemed that senior high school students tended to possess it. This belief made the mistakes made during the application of strategies more intolerable for the students.

The pursuit of accuracy also lowered learners' tolerance of ambiguity. In the current study, it was reported that anxieties would be raised when the students encountered ambiguities resulting from the use of the language learning strategies such as, "To understand unfamiliar English words, I make guesses". The students seemed to believe that they should always give correct answers. Therefore, when the students were asked to make guesses, they would prefer to look for correct answer rather than give an uncertain one. It was also reported that, without accurate answers, senior high school students would lose their feeling of security (Huang, 1997, p. 181). Therefore, the students tended to guess only when guessing was the last resort, such as during a test or when there is no dictionary. They had formed looking for accuracy as a habit in learning.

Anxiety raised after applying the language learning strategies

It was reported that after applying some strategies, the students would think that their English was poor, and this made them feel anxious. For example, they were anxious when they could not understand others, when they encountered unfamiliar words and needed to make a guess, or when they spoke English without accuracy, fluency, or good pronunciation. It seemed that the students tended to evaluate themselves negatively when they were faced with troubles. Unfortunately, the effect of the negative feeling seemed to last and influence the students' choices of learning strategies till the next time. That is, if the students were not confident of their English ability or felt anxious after using strategies, they would not choose the strategies again. As was pointed out by MacIntyre (1994), anxiety and self-confidence were the reasons for learners not to use strategies.

Brief Summary

The results of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties indicated that there were six difficulties and three kinds of anxieties the students encountered when choosing or using language learning strategies. It was reported that the unfamiliarity of language learning

strategies, the requirement of English ability, the EFL language learning environment, the feeling of being embarrassed, the passive learning attitude, and the heavy academic load from school would hinder learners' learning strategy choices.

Anxieties would be raised before, during, and after the application of learning strategies. The fear of making mistakes and being embarrassed made the students feel anxious before using a language learning strategy. The mistakes made and the confusion caused during the application of learning strategies also raised anxieties. Finally, the negative judgments about themselves, resulting from the failure of strategy-application, made the students anxious after the application of language learning strategies.

CHAPTER SIX

CONCLUSION AND PEDAGOGICAL IMPLICATIONS

In the current study, the researcher investigated the predictors of language learning strategy choices of 178 senior high school students in Taiwan. To examine the predictors, the researcher started by testing of the social-psychological model proposed by MacIntyre in 1994. In this model, it was believed that a learner would use a strategy if he or she knows it well, feels it effective, and has no reason not to use it. In addition to testing the predictability of this model in predicting language learning strategy choices, the researcher further explored the reasons that prevented the students from using language learning strategies. In the social-psychological model, *difficulty* and *anxiety* were two variables that served as reasons which prevented learners from using strategies. As a result, the possible difficulties and anxieties of the students, when choosing or using learning strategies, were investigated.

Conclusion

The results of the test of the social-psychological model indicated that the predictability of the model was weak. The model only predicted 23 learning strategies in the SILL (Oxford, 1989), with an average predictability of 53%. It is possible that there were other variables in the model more strongly related to the strategy choices of senior high school students. Besides, there is still a large area to be explored in locating effective predictors of language learning strategy choices of senior high school students in Taiwan. For example, from the literature review of the studies investigating senior high school students in Taiwan, motivation and proficiency (Ku, 1995), gender (Yang, 1991; Ku, 1995) and language learning beliefs (Huang, 1997) were all reported as factors influencing strategy choices.

Although the predictability of the model was weak, the variables *knowledge*, *anxiety*, and *difficulty* were found to be good predictors; these three variables predicted the frequency

of strategy use in most of the items in the SILL. Also, significant correlation coefficients between the frequency of strategy use and the four variables in the model were found.

The results of the investigation of difficulties and anxieties of the students when using learning strategies indicated that there were mainly six types of difficulties and three kinds of anxieties. Difficulties that would impede the students' learning strategy application were the unfamiliarity of language learning strategies, the requirement of English ability, the EFL language learning environment, the feeling of being embarrassed, the passive learning attitude, and the heavy academic load from school. Anxieties would be raised before, during, and after the application of language learning strategies. Possible factors that caused anxieties were the fear of making mistakes and getting embarrassed before using a strategy, the fact of making mistakes and getting embarrassed, the feeling of uncertainty when using a strategy, and the negative feelings after applying learning strategies.

Pedagogical Implications

The current study aimed to locate the predictors of language learning strategy choices of senior high school students in Taiwan. The researcher also investigated different types of difficulties and anxieties that prevent learners from using language learning strategies. The pedagogical implications of the current study are as the following.

Firstly, it was reported that the four variables *knowledge*, *effectiveness*, *anxiety* and *difficulty* in the social-psychological model were significantly related with the frequency of strategy use. Therefore, when language learning strategies are taught, learners should be well-informed about the way in which strategies should be applied. In addition, teachers and learning strategy trainers are suggested to reduce the difficulties and anxieties of using learning strategies, and let learners experience the effectiveness of these strategies.

Secondly, it was reported that difficulties such as the unfamiliarity of a strategy, the requirement of English ability, the EFL language learning environment, the feeling of being

embarrassed, the passive learning attitude, and the heavy academic load from school would prevent learners from applying learning strategies. It is suggested that teachers and learning strategy trainers make efforts to solve the problems resulting from learners' difficulties. For example, teachers and trainers are suggested to create situations for learners to use learning strategies in the EFL language learning environment. It is also suggested that teachers and trainers should encourage learners to use strategies even if the learners' English ability is poor.

Thirdly, the students were reported to have anxieties before using learning strategies because of the fear of making mistakes and being embarrassed. Also, actually making mistakes and being embarrassed along with the feeling of uncertainty when using a strategy, raised anxieties. Further, the negative feeling after applying learning strategies caused anxieties. It is suggested that teachers and learning strategy trainers should offer their help to reduce learners' anxieties. For example, inadequate language learning beliefs, such as the pursuit of accuracy and sense of security, may result in anxieties when applying language learning strategies. It is suggested that trainers and teachers modify these inadequate beliefs and give learners informed beliefs when learning languages. For example, teachers and trainers are suggested to encourage learners to speak out even if they can't speak well. In addition, it is important for learners to have successful experience of strategy-application because the unsuccessful experience would make learners feel anxious and unconfident about themselves. Teachers and trainers are suggested to let learners have successful strategy-application experience. Even if the application of language learning strategies fails, teachers and trainers are suggested to help learners find out the factors resulting in the failure of learning strategies. Thus learners would not judge themselves negatively and would not fear to use strategies again.

Limitations of the Study

The limitations of the current study are as follows. Firstly, the data of the current study was based on self-reported questionnaires. As long as a self-reported questionnaire is used, researchers take a risk that participants may not offer honest answers.

Secondly, the questionnaires involved in this study were lengthy, and this may have led to the weariness of the participants when completing the questionnaires. This may influence the reliability of the results of the questionnaires. Although the researcher in the current study offered enough time for all the participants, and encouraged honest answers without a rush, the students may still have felt tired by the end of the lengthy questionnaire.

Thirdly, the current study was a case study, focusing on second-grade senior high school students in central Taiwan. Therefore, researchers who want to use the results and findings need to carefully examine the background of the study and the similarity of the participants.

Finally, the current study focused on testing the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994); however, it should be noted that there is still a large area to be explored in the field of language learning strategies. In addition, the results suggested that, in the model, there might be other social-psychological variables which strongly relate to the strategy choices of senior high school students. What these variables are and how these variables influence strategy choices are the tasks which need further investigations.

Suggestions for Future Research

Suggestions for future studies are as follows. Firstly, future studies involving self-reported questionnaires could possibly adopt a second or third research method to triangulate the data and increase the reliability and validity of studies.

Secondly, future studies involving lengthy questionnaires would be better to break the questionnaires into several parts, and administer each part with sufficient time. Researchers

should develop a good relationship with the participants and encourage honest answers with clear instructions. In addition, the time allowed to complete the questionnaire should be sufficient. Every step should be carefully administered to increase on the reliability of the results of the current study.

Thirdly, in the current study, the researcher aimed to locate the predictors of the strategy choices of senior high school students by testing the social-psychological model of MacIntyre (1994). To validate the findings of the current study, research which aims to duplicate the current study are invited. Studies on language learning strategy training are also needed. These studies can not only validate the major findings of the current study but also give more suggestions on training methods. Studies are also required to investigate different and more efficient predictors. Such studies would help us know more about the whole picture of language learning strategy choices and contribute insight into strategy training programs.

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APPENDIX 1

The Quantitative Questionnaire

各位同學，感謝您參與此份問卷的作答。本問卷旨在瞭解您在學習英語時，所使用的語言學習策略情形。本問卷並沒有正確答案，同時，您的答案本研究人員將予以保密，請各位同學安心作答。

本問卷共分成五部分。作答方式是將您所選的答案圈選出來即可。1----2----3----4----5 為一量尺，兩極端為程度 1 以及程度 5，程度 3 為中間，請您將您使用英語語言學習策略的情形（哪一個程度）用筆圈選出來。例如：

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第一部份：學習策略的認識

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1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。
2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。
3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。
4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。
5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。

感謝您的熱心幫助。

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第一部份：學習策略的認識

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1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。
2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。
3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。
4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。
5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。
6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。
7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。
8. 我時常複習英文功課。
9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。
10. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。
11. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。
12. 我練習英語發音。
13. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。
14. 我嘗試以英文交談。
15. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。
16. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。
17. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。
18. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。
19. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。
20. 我試著找出英文的句型。
21. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。
22. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。
23. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。
24. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。
25. 英文對話時，若突然有個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。
26. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。
27. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。
28. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。
29. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。
30. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。
31. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。
32. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。
33. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。
34. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。
35. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。

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第一部份：學習策略的認識

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36. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。
37. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。
38. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。
39. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。
40. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。
41. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。
42. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。
43. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。
44. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。
45. 假如在英語會話有聽不懂之處，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。
46. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。
47. 我和其他同學練習英文。
48. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。
49. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。
50. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。

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第二部份：學習策略的使用

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1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。
2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。
3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。
4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。
5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。
6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。
7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。
8. 我時常複習英文功課。
9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。
10. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。
11. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。
12. 我練習英語發音。
13. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。

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第二部份：學習策略的使用

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| 1---2---3---4---5 | 14. 我嘗試以英文交談。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 15. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 16. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 17. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 18. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 19. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 20. 我試著找出英文的句型。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 21. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 22. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 23. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 24. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 25. 英文對話時，若突然有個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 26. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 27. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 28. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 29. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 30. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 31. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 32. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 33. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 34. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 35. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 36. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 37. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 38. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 39. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 40. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 41. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 42. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 43. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 44. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 45. 假如在英語會話有聽不懂之處，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 46. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 47. 我和其他同學練習英文。 |

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第二部份：學習策略的使用

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48. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。

49. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。

50. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。

完全無效

非常有效

第三部份：學習策略的效果

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

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1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1---2---3---4---5

1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。

2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。

3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。

4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。

5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。

6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。

7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。

8. 我時常複習英文功課。

9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。

10. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。

11. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。

12. 我練習英語發音。

13. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。

14. 我嘗試以英文交談。

15. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。

16. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。

17. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。

18. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。

19. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。

20. 我試著找出英文的句型。

21. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。

22. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。

23. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。

24. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。

25. 英文對話時，若突然有個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。

完全無效

非常有效

第三部份：學習策略的效果

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 26. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 27. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 28. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 29. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 30. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 31. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 32. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 33. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 34. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 35. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 36. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 37. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 38. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 39. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 40. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 41. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 42. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 43. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 44. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 45. 假如在英語會話有聽不懂之處，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 46. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 47. 我和其他同學練習英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 48. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 49. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 50. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。 |

十分焦慮

不會焦慮

第四部份：學習策略的使用感覺

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。 |

第四部份：學習策略的使用感覺

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 8. 我時常複習英文功課。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 10. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 11. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 12. 我練習英語發音。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 13. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 14. 我嘗試以英文交談。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 15. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 16. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 17. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 18. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 19. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 20. 我試著找出英文的句型。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 21. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 22. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 23. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 24. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 25. 英文對話時，若突然有個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 26. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 27. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 28. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 29. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 30. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 31. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 32. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 33. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 34. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 35. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 36. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 37. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。 |

十分
焦慮

不會
焦慮

第四部份：學習策略的使用感覺

- 1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5

38. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。
39. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。
40. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。
41. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。
42. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。
43. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。
44. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。
45. 假如在英語會話有聽不懂之處，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。
46. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。
47. 我和其他同學練習英文。
48. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。
49. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。
50. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。

十分
困難

十分
簡單

第五部份：學習策略的使用難易

- 1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5
1----2----3----4----5

1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。
2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。
3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。
4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。
5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。
6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。
7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。
8. 我時常複習英文功課。
9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。
10. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。
11. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。
12. 我練習英語發音。
13. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。
14. 我嘗試以英文交談。
15. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。
16. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。
17. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。

第五部份：學習策略的使用難易

- | | |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 18. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 19. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 20. 我試著找出英文的句型。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 21. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 22. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 23. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 24. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 25. 英文對話時，若突然有個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 26. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 27. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 28. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 29. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 30. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 31. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 32. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 33. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 34. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 35. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 36. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 37. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 38. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 39. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 40. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 41. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 42. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 43. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 44. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 45. 假如在英語會話有聽不懂之處，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 46. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 47. 我和其他同學練習英文。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 48. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 49. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。 |
| 1---2---3---4---5 | 50. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。 |

APPENDIX 2

The Qualitative Questionnaire

各位同學，感謝您參與此份問卷的作答。本問卷旨在瞭解您在學習英語時，所使用的語言學習策略情形。本問卷並沒有正確答案，同時，您的答案本研究人員將予以保密，請各位同學安心作答。

本問卷共分六部分。每一部份各代表一種學習策略。請先閱讀每一部份的英語學習策略。閱讀之後，請回答每一部份以下的兩個問題。

- 1) 請選出二種學習策略是您在使用上會有困難的，並舉例說明困難之處。
- 2) 請選出二種學習策略是您在使用時會造成您的焦慮的，並舉例說明是什麼樣的焦慮，以及引起焦慮的原因。

例如：第三部分

1. 例如遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。
2. 在英文對話時，如果突然有一個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。
3. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。
4. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。
5. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。
6. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用上會有困難的，並舉例說明困難之處。

1. 6, 不知道其他意思相通的字詞
2. 2, 有時候不一定比的出來

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用時會造成您的焦慮的，並舉例說明是什麼樣的焦慮，以及引起焦慮的原因。

1. 3, 讀英文時若有我不知道的單字，我會感到焦慮，無法繼續讀下去，所以我一定要馬上查字典
2. 2, 我不太會用肢體語言表達

問題採開放式回答，請知無不言，言無不盡。謝謝您的合作。

第一部份：

1. 我會把新學的東西和已學過的部份做聯想。
2. 我用新學的單字造句，以加深記憶。
3. 我會把英文單字的發音和這個字的形象或圖像連想起來，以幫助記憶。
4. 我藉著想像使用某個英文字的可能狀況，來記憶那個單字。
5. 我利用相類似的發音來記憶英文生字。
6. 我使用單字卡來背英文生字。
7. 我用肢體語言來幫助記憶單字。
8. 我時常複習英文功課。
9. 我靠英文單字或片語出現在書上、黑板上、或路標上的位置來記憶。

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用上會有困難的，並舉例說明困難之處。

1. _____

2. _____

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用時會造成您的焦慮的，並舉例說明是什麼樣的焦慮，以及引起焦慮的原因。

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第二部份：

1. 我會反覆練習說或寫英文生字。
2. 我試著說得像以英文為母語的人一樣。
3. 我練習英語發音。
4. 我以不同的方式使用我所知道的英文字。
5. 我嘗試以英文交談。
6. 我看英語發音的電視節目或電影。
7. 我讀英文書報以作為娛樂、消遣。
8. 我用英文寫筆記、留言、寫信或報告。
9. 我先很快瀏覽英文片段，然後再回頭仔細研讀。
10. 我看到英文單字時會想一想中文裡哪一個字有類似的意思。
11. 我試著找出英文的句型。
12. 我把一個英文單字拆成幾個我認得的部份，以找出它的意思。
13. 我避免一個字一個字翻成中文或英文。
14. 我將所聽到或讀到的英文做摘要整理。

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用上會有困難的，並舉例說明困難之處。

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第三部份：

1. 遇到不熟悉的英文字時，我會用猜的。
2. 在英文對話時，如果突然有一個單字想不起來，我會利用比手劃腳來表達。
3. 當我想不出適切的英文字時，我會自己發明新的單字。
4. 讀英文時，我不會每一個單字都去查字典。
5. 我會去猜測別人下一句要說的英文。
6. 當我想不出某個英文字時，我會利用其他意思相通的字詞。

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第四部份：

1. 我會盡可能地找出各種方式來運用我所學的英文。
2. 我會留意自己的英文錯誤，並利用它來改進。
3. 當有人在說英文時，我會特別注意聽。
4. 我試著找出如何學好英文的方法。
5. 我會訂定作息表，使自己有足夠的時間讀英文。
6. 我會尋找可以和我講英文的人。
7. 我會尋找機會盡可能地讀英文。
8. 我有明確的目標，決定要加強自己的英文。
9. 我會考量自己學習英文的進展。

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第五部份：

1. 每當我害怕使用英文時，我會試著放鬆自己。
2. 即使害怕犯錯，我還是會鼓勵自己說英文。
3. 每當我在英文上表現很好時，我會獎勵自己。
4. 當我讀英文或說英文的時候，我注意自己是否會緊張。
5. 我在學習語言記錄本子上，寫下自己的學習心得。
6. 我會和別人討論自己學英文的感受。

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第六部份：

1. 假如在英語會話時，我有聽不懂的地方，我會要求對方說慢一點或再講一遍。
2. 說英語時，我會要求對方改正我的錯誤。
3. 我和其他同學練習英文。
4. 我會向講英文的人尋求協助。
5. 我會發問以澄清和證實英文上的問題。
6. 我試著瞭解英語系國家（說英文為主的國家）的文化。

■ 請選出二種學習策略(寫下編號即可)是您在使用上會有困難的，並舉例說明困難之處。

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